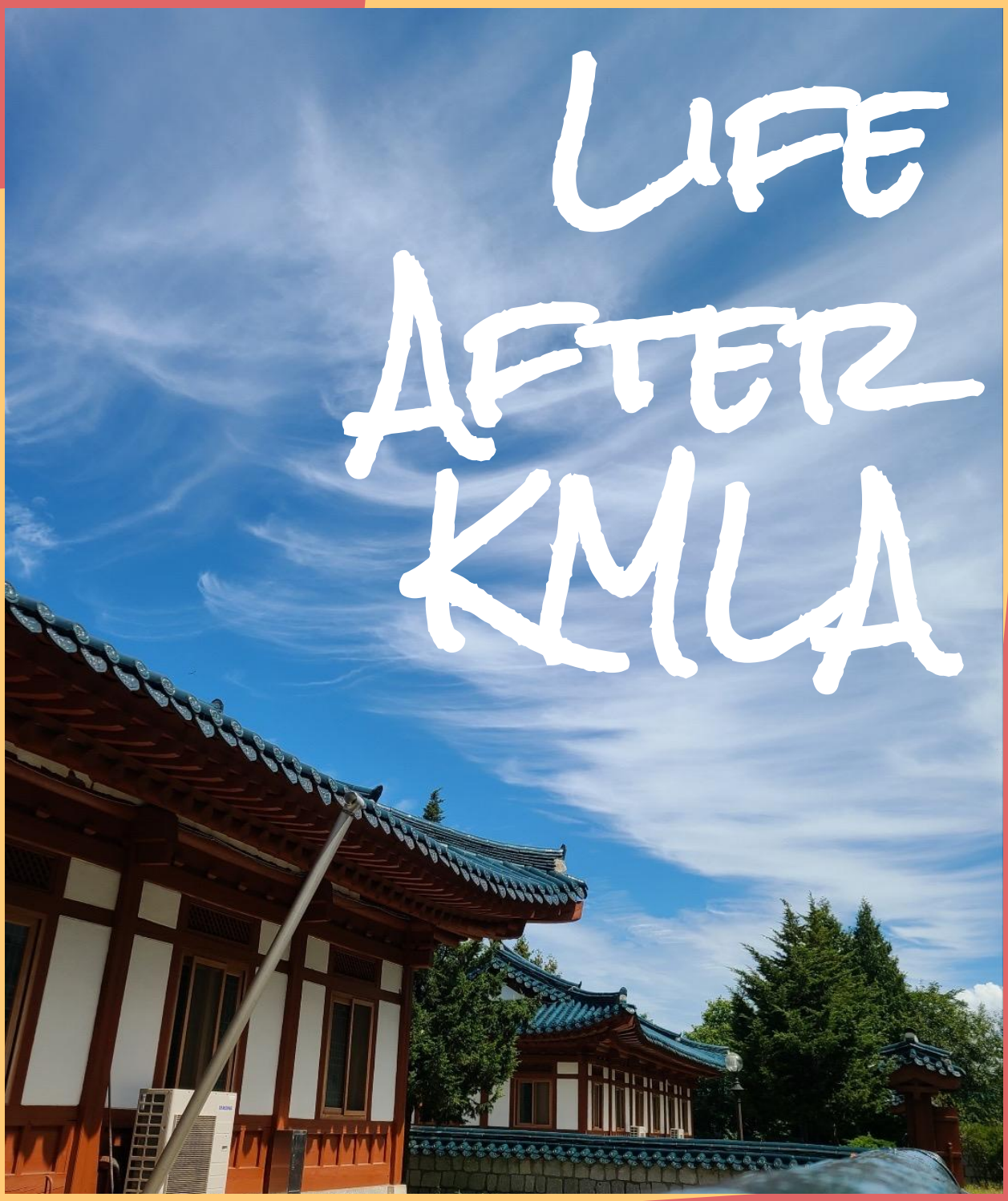
MINJOK HERALD

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Editor's Note



It is with great pleasure and relief that my team and I are able to deliver this edition to you, ten months after I first stood in front of you as the head of press for the 33rd student body election.

As you are all aware, *Minjok Herald* has struggled in the aftermath of COVID-19, with the school's academic calendar disturbed and us in quarantine. I took over as editor-in-chief in march with determination to recover from the pandemic and get student press back in motion.

I'd like to thank each member of the editorial team for their contributions made to The Minjok Herald, with a unified goal to reinvented this publication as something by and for the students.

The editorial team released a brand new edition of the stylebook; changed our internal writing procedures and team structures in an effort to increase productivity; made significant changes to the press releases for student council elections; established a private Facebook page just for KMLA students to strengthen freedom of the press; made changes to the newspaper's layout and content.

The writers, designers, and photographers of Minjok Herald faced various hurdles over the past months we spent working on this issue. Though we are still working hard to attain our goal, the 67th edition of the *Minjok Herald* represents the culmination of our endeavors over the last months.

I, therefore, want to ask for your active support and continued attention, just as I did when the Facebook group initially launched. Your engagement is essential to achieving our aim because, to repeat myself, student press—or any sort of press, for that matter—is incomplete without its readership.

We will continue to make every effort to become the students' eyes, ears, and voices.

Thank you,

Chaehyeon Moon

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THE NEW ENTRANCE TO KMLA CAMPUS

KMLA recently constructed a brand-new school gate. The gate that KMLA initially used was attached to the company "Pasteur." This was quite inconvenient, and it was also unsafe for the students. Everyone had access to the school in this setting. The entrance and school gates for KMLA are now independent. Our school gate was rebuilt, making it considerably safer for pupils.

The new school gate has a system for identifying cars, and whenever a car approaches the gate, the system detects the vehicle and opens the gate for it. For instance, a "parent's vehicle" is recognized when a parent comes to visit. This strengthened security in our school by preventing guests without identification from entering.

By doing this, it increased safety in our school since visitors who do not have access to the school are banned from coming in. Along the road to the new gate, there is a new road towards the school building. This road is smoother than other roads at school, so even in the hard snowing times which happen often in KMLA, it is easier for teachers and parents to come to visit students at KMLA. Many teachers, students, and caregivers are satisfied with the school gate. One of the parents said “I’m thankful for the school changing the gate since it looks better on the outside. It looks neat and tidier, and it’s brightening the school image overall compared to the previous gate we had. Not just the appearance of the school gate but also the safety enhancement by changing the gate is very satisfying”. Lots of teachers also showed gratitude for changing the school building.

The change in the school gate was very exciting even during summer. It was a great choice to change the entrance since freshman interview season is going on and it’s giving a great impression to freshmen, their family members, and visitors. We hope to see more change around school bringing positive effects.

Junior Writer | Yi Inyoung



GOODBYE, 25TH WAVERS!

In this world, meeting entails parting. School may be the place that demonstrates this the best. It’s a ginormous plaza of meeting those who have absolutely no ties nor similarities with you, and under the commonality of ‘school’, new relationships are nurtured. However, in every school, there is parting, as grade groups leave school after completing their time at school. This time, we say goodbye to our seniors, the 25th wavers.

25th wavers are truly one of the strongest wavers that have ever existed. Starting from year 1, the 25th wavers were hit directly with the COVID-19 pandemic, in which they had to return home for weeks, unsure when to return. The comfortable and convenient precedents previous wavers had set for the school were now inapplicable in such new, unconventional circumstances. The 25th wavers had to make their own way work.







It's the bare minimum to say that these 25th wavers did a great job settling in, even welcoming in the 26th and 27th wavers as they started their lives at Korean Minjok Leadership Academy. Despite their hardships, they made the new wavers’ entrance easier, helping them into their school lives with advice, help and fun memories shared.

To start the 2023 school year without the 25th wavers who we have always relied on, will be strange. However, they have left KMLA to start the next chapter of their lives in diverse fields and locations. The KMLA family wishes them the greatest luck with the loudest applause as they make their next step. Goodbye, 25th wavers! You will be missed.

Senior Writer | Kang Chaewon

ALMA MATER HOMECOMING DAY

FIRST TIME HELD IN 3 YEARS

The "Alma Mater Homecoming Day" is Korean Minjok Leadership Academy's traditional event held every year in which students visit the middle schools they graduated from to thank their former teachers. After being put on pause due to COVID-19, the event was finally held again for the first time in 3 years after pandemic restrictions relaxed. Thus, all students from freshmen to seniors were experiencing it for the first time.

Beyond thanking their middle school teachers, students also introduced KMLA to the students of the middle school they attended. KMLA students from the same middle schools grouped together and organized their visits. Dressed in formal school uniform, *yebok*, to show full respect, they presented promotional materials prepared by the *Public Relations* team, including pamphlets and a video.

A poll was conducted on the 27th wavers and Changdeok Girls' Middle School students on what they gained from this event. Here are some of the many positive responses from the 27th wavers on the event:

It was nice going to the middle school after a long time and it was fun. It was also a good opportunity to get to know the senior students from the same middle school.

When I was a middle school student I met graduates who went to well-known high schools and I dreamed of becoming like them. I thought I should also study hard to go to the school I want. I was happy to be able to make my dream come true. Also, It was worthwhile because it seeamed like I had instilled dreams in someone else and had a positive impact on the middle school students. Moreover, it felt new to meet the teachers who taught and guided me for three years.

Many students were pleased to meet their teachers and were proud to introduce KMLA to students of the middle school that they graduated from.

The middle school students also gave responses. A third-grader from Changdeok Girls' Middle School said that she did not have much chance to learn about KMLA, but, thanks to the event, she got the chance to meet graduates who went to this school. After listening to the presentation, she has become interested in KMLA. Another student replied that "The way classes are conducted in KMLA was interesting, and the fact that students can choose the color of the uniform was unique."

The Alma Mater Homecoming day was a special chance for students to meet their middle school teachers and thank them officially. Moreover, they also met middle school students and introduced KMLA to them. Now that the COVID-19 storm has calmed, students and teachers of both KMLA and the middle schools hope that the Alma Mater Homecoming Day can be held every year.

Junior Writer
Ok Jung-In



"KMLA IS ALWAYS READY TO LISTEN TO YOUR STORIES"



Every person has their own concerns locked in their heart–especially if one is far away from their family and stressed out with their studies like the state Korean Minjok Leadership Academy's students are in. The question is, are those unspeakable worries well-expressed? KMLA offers diverse counseling programs to listen to students' "unspeakable worries." It also has its own office for student counseling programs dedicated to our mental health, marks, and career paths. Counseling centers are also widely located in the dormitory, Dasan Hall, and some teachers' offices.

KMLA counseling rooms provide counseling programs that help students to make the most out of their high school years, both educationally and mentally. The school annually carries out psychological testing such as the 'Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI)' and 'Youth Self Report (YSR).' The school counseling program incorporates a student-responsibility counseling system and guarantees special care for the students.

To help the students to easily approach, there is a counseling room on the first floor of the Deokgo House.

Professional residing counselor Dr. Oh Wo-Nui's individual counseling sessions are popular these days.

Many students choose to visit Dr. Oh for personal conversations after school. Dr. Oh states that counseling requires a lot of patience. Standardized psychological tests were also used for counseling.

She pinpointed that even though MBTI test is prevalent on the internet these days, objective data are necessary to analyze the counselee. One of the former counselees of Dr. Oh, 10th grader Song Da-Hyun, shared that baring her heart to the counseling teacher freed her from an internal burden. Moreover, she was able to find a solution by having a deep conversation with Dr. Oh.

Students can also reach their advisors for counseling. Each grade has a counseling teacher chosen from the advisors of the grade. Min So-Jung, one of the 10th rade advisors as well as the 10th-grade representative counseling advisor, reported that students who request counseling have significantly decreased over the last few years.

She said they usually have deep conversations on friendship, grades, course selections, and recently, the conversation topics the students bring on have became limited to college and grade issues. Even a few years ago,

there were even plenty of students coming up with relationship issues. She highly suggested having more counselors for each grade could boost individual-level counseling. The noteworthy point was that those individual-level counseling should already be done with advisors. The noteworthy point she indicated that some advisors do not understand the importance of one-to-one talk with their students. "I hope that student-advisor counseling becomes a thing of common sense among KMLA society," concluded Mrs. Min in the interview.

Not only the conversation with the teachers, but also the horizontal conversations are opened to students. *Soksagim*, a counseling center-affiliated club, is constituted of KMLA students who listen to and counsel students with the motto 'We stand by you.' They guarantee anonymity by also providing a Kakaotalk open chat link.

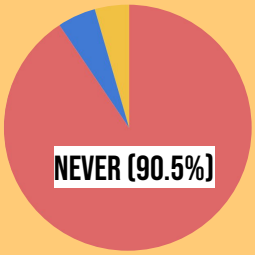
KMLA students shared their opinions about the current counseling system. In a survey on counseling room usage rates conducted on twenty-one KMLA students, 90.5% of students were reported to have never used the counseling room before, and the reason for it varied from assuming that using counseling rooms can be useless, and feeling bothersome to visit there, or feeling like discussing with their parents or solving the problem by themselves would be better. Students who have taken advantage of the counseling program showed positive reactions to revisiting the program. Still, all the respondents replied they could also feel reluctant to visit the counseling room since there is still a small chance for their conversation to leak to others. This shows that students have trust but at the same time mistrust towards the school counseling program.

However, there are still regrets: KMLA students gave specific opinions on things to improve for our counseling program. There were several replies that students aren't aware of the specific way to contact the counseling rooms, such as the dorm room center or the peer-counseling club. "Once, I had to use the counseling room for my peer-counseling conversation. However, I had a hard time reaching the school counselor." Another student noted that counseling programs lacked promotion.

KMLA's counseling programs are diverse, beneficial, as well as widely open to students. The programs are a great resource for students' mental health. While there are areas to improve on, such as increasing accessibility, students should not forget that the school is always ready to listen to our "unspeakable worries." Whenever you are having a hard time, why don't you consider dropping by the counseling center?

HOW MANY TIMES DO YOU VISIT THE COUNSELING ROOM PER SEMESTER ?

In a survey conducted by Minjok Herald, 90.5% of the 21 students who answered responded that they do not visit the counseling room at all. About 5% responded that they visit the counseling room once per semester, and the other 5% 2-3 times.



Junior Writer
Lee Yena

MVP

: WINNER OF THE STATE CHAMPIONSHIP LEAGUE HELD AFTER 3 YEARS OF STAND BY



AN EXCLUSIVE INTERVIEW PIECE BY SENIOR WRITER KWAK DOYEON



On June 11th, 2022, great news was delivered as the *Minjok Volleyball Player* (MVP) achieved victory in the Gangwon State Championship. As a school that emphasizes the values of health, virtue, and intelligence, KMLA's many sports clubs, including *MVP*, kendo club, *Game Over*, *Raffiné*, and *KBO*, proudly returned to school with awards in their arms. *Minjok Herald* interviewed one of the winning teams, MVP.

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Would you introduce MVP?
MVP was formed in 2006 as a girls' volleyball club, and now it is a mixed volleyball club. The goal of MVP is to enjoy volleyball, and if possible, take the joy to another level and make accomplishments at competitions.

How did you prepare for the league?
All the members of MVP invested a lot of time and energy into the regular and intense practices since March. We practiced at least 7 hours a week including sports club period on Wednesdays, every first self-study period on Wednesday, Tuesday, and Friday after school, and 2 hours on weekends, even when the final exam was just around the corner.

Indeed, hardships did exist. Intense practices were tiring and even some of the junior members suffered from slipped discs in their necks. We had concerns about the final exam upcoming in a week, and going to the championship did put substantial burdens on us. Once we arrived at the stadium, however, all concerns washed away.

The game and the time we spent together outside school were so exciting that we felt our efforts were worth it.

What happened at the competition?
On the big day, we were slightly intimidated by the powerful spikes that our opponents from Gangwon Foreign Language High School were practicing. Soon the game began, and each of us pretended to be calm but we were all nervous during the early stage of the game.

Our biggest concern was that 'We must win as the first team from our school to come to the state championship league this year and also as the first to upload the result on Facebook. What a shame it would be if we have no words to upload?'
We won most of our points from great serves, and the game ended in 40 minutes after 2 rounds.

What do you consider as the primary reason for your victory?
The nervousness and anxiousness eased away soon after the game began.
Looking back at this point, we never lost confidence in our ability during the game, which originated from our long history of intense practices and trust in each other.

The sentence "It's okay. You did great," automatically came out in eagerness to comfort one another.
It cured our faces gone pale whenever someone felt guilty by the thought she had messed up.

How do you feel about your accomplishment?
First the satisfaction came that we were able to deliver good news to KMLA. Then came the pride that our effort paid off.
It felt a little empty since the boys of MVP weren't there because they were not able to participate in the league. We hope that all members will be able to celebrate together at another competition. Members of MVP often say "I have a headache. I better play volleyball," or "No matter how much I feel depressed, it eases away the instant I come to the volleyball court," or even "When the moment of death comes, I will take a volleyball in my hands to heaven." Likewise, we consider playing volleyball as a panacea, and sincerely adore the art of playing.

Every member appears to have a substantial depth of passion, and even love, towards MVP. The vitality and persistence of a club are often determined by the bonds between its members, and great relationships are formed through a shared passion. Conflicts are inevitable in a community;z nevertheless, they can transform into solidarity when members show effort to solve situations through conversation and persuasion rather than coercion. A round of applause to all sports clubs that devoted their time and sweat!



WHAT KMLA STUDENTS WANT TO DO ONCE THE PANDEMIC ENDS

In some ways, COVID-19 has come to an end. Freedom of travel has returned and wearing masks outdoors and keeping distance between each other is no longer mandatory. As we are now finally leaving three long years of quarantine behind, *Minjok Herald* examined the new sense of freedom that is developing and what the *new normal* of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy's students might look like.

In the process, *Minjok Herald* surveyed 78 students in 10th grade. When they were asked, "What do you want to do when the pandemic ends?", 51% of the students answered 'visiting *huegaeso*.' The second most prevailing answer was 'traveling' which rated about 35%, and the last was 'going to concerts' which rated about 11%. The remaining 3% of the students wanted to do other things such as going for a walk without masks on or hanging out with their friends freely, etc.

Many students have expressed the desire to visit *huegaeso* with the easing of school quarantine regulations. Before the pandemic, students were allowed to go to *huegaeso* during weekends and holidays. They could eat food outside of school and were able to take a walk with friends. It was how many students relieve stress and recharged before a new week.

However, as the pandemic commenced and became worse, this became impossible. Students had to stay inside the campus; all they could do instead was eat at the cafeteria and take a walk inside the grounds. With eased restrictions, many students look forward to visiting the *huegaeso*.

Next, traveling was another thing many students hoped to do. Because of the pandemic, traveling between countries was inhibited, but now airplane reservations are overflowing. KMLA students now seek rest and expect to enjoy the forbidden trips they've missed out on for over three years. The destinations students preferred most were Hawaii, Saipan, and Bali.

Lastly, the third most anticipated activity was going to concerts of favorite artists. We are no longer limited to watching live streamed no-audience concerts. With the lifted regulations for the size of crowds allowed to gather, KMLA students can now look forward to the high excitement and thrill of being at the stadium together with other fans and their beloved stars.

To sum up, KMLA students want to enjoy going outside the school freely, especially to visit the *huegaeso*, to travel abroad, and to attend concerts. As COVID-19 and lockdowns are heading to an end, students are able to spend their free time doing what they want happily!

Junior Writer

Kim Do-Gyeong



LIFE AFTER KMLA

INTO THE NEW WORLD

MINJOK HERALD 67TH EDITION SPOTLIGHT THEME

For KMLA students, every day is a bustling day packed with a ton of academics, tests, presentations, club activities, sports, and so much more. But what happens after we graduate from this school after three years of hard work? Would we be ready to confront the real world right away? What is it like outside this unique, small society of ours located in the distant countryside? To find out what happens after we leave the familiar Dukgo dorms, Minjok Herald conducted research and reached out to numerous KMLA alumni.

THE ROAD TO BECOMING ONE OF THE WORLD'S BRIGHTEST PROBLEM-SOLVERS

– A CAREER INTERVIEW IN CONSULTING WITH 8TH WAVER AMY RYU

First, why and when did you decide to become a consultant?
I majored in mechanical engineering at university, but realistically, I didn't see myself devoting myself to a particular company nor did I want to be working in the automobile industry.

Then in junior year, I happened to take a business class with a friend who was so good at putting together presentations and talking in front of a class. I told her "your presentations are beautiful, you're so good at presenting arguments, you always tell a story."

When she responded that she got her skills while doing an internship in consulting at Oliver Wyman, I didn't even know what consulting was. My friend told me that it was a job where you go to different companies and you help them figure out problems. I was interested so I decided to apply for the internship.

How exactly did you become a consultant? Could you give us more details about the process?
Sure. There are these things called case interviews, where you are basically given a hypothetical business problem and then you walk through the problem. They're not really curious about the answer, but more about how you structure the problem, how you think through it, and stuff like that. I did about seven or eight interviews, and I practised in front of a friend so I could get a feel for it. I think that was the most critical part of preparing for the case interviews.

Is there a specific major that consulting firms prefer? Or would one be able to try regardless of the major?
I think it really depends on the field. There are many different types of consultants—I dealt with technology and engineering because that was my major, but that's not the case for everyone. If you want to do analytic consulting, you should try to do more engineering or maths-based majors; if you think you care more about business structures or strategies, you should consider a business major; if you care about the finance part of a business then you should be a finance major; if you care more about the human interaction of a business, sociology your psychology is for you. Your major should be what you're passionate about, and then if you do end up in consulting, then you can find projects within the industry that have special ties to it.

Consultants are famous for the amount of travel their profession requires them to do. Is this true for everyone?
Again, it depends a lot on the job. I travelled from Monday to Thursday every week of my three and a half years as a consultant, which honestly was so much fun! It's really fun when you're starting off your career by travelling with your teammates.

But it doesn't have to be that way. For example, let's say that you are a consultant specializing in services, and you live in New York. Then you're not going to travel because all your clients are going to be in New York. Or, let's say you are a consultant and you work primarily with technology firms and you live in San Francisco. Then you're not going to travel either because all your clients will be there. I think it's very hard to be like 'okay, consulting is this' because it just depends on what type of consultant you are, and where you work.

Travelling every week from Monday to Thursday, how did you maintain your work-life balance?
I think there are two things.

One, I really leaned into my teammates. My teammates are some of my closest friends, even to this day. When you're working those hours, you want to be having a good time with your friends.

Also, I think it's really important to understand what keeps you going. Me, I love working out, so I would make sure that I have time to work out during the week. My only free times were in the mornings because in the evenings I'd be working. So it meant that I had to wake up early in the mornings to work out, and this is actually crazy because when I was in KMLA, I was not a morning person and I hated morning workouts.

Who would you recommend this career path to?
I recommend this to someone who's always bored and lacking new things to do. With consulting, every three to four months you are always on a brand new project in a new area. You have no idea what's going on and you have to spend a lot of time learning about an entirely new thing. Then you've got to go digging down the client's data: interview everybody, seek out information, and absorb your stuff.



the Hong Kong office of Mckinsey & Company , a consulting firm
Source: Deezn

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As a woman of color living in the US who's also a Korean citizen and not an American, were there any difficulties in the course of starting off or continuing your career?
I want people to remember that the process was hard, but it was not impossible. Honestly, this is so far in the future. I'd not worry about this at all or let it get in the way of my dreams for now. There are so many big companies in the US that are looking for good talent. You'll figure it out one day. And I also want to add, I'd like women of color to be bold. There is a stereotype that Asian women are quiet, they're well-behaved, right?

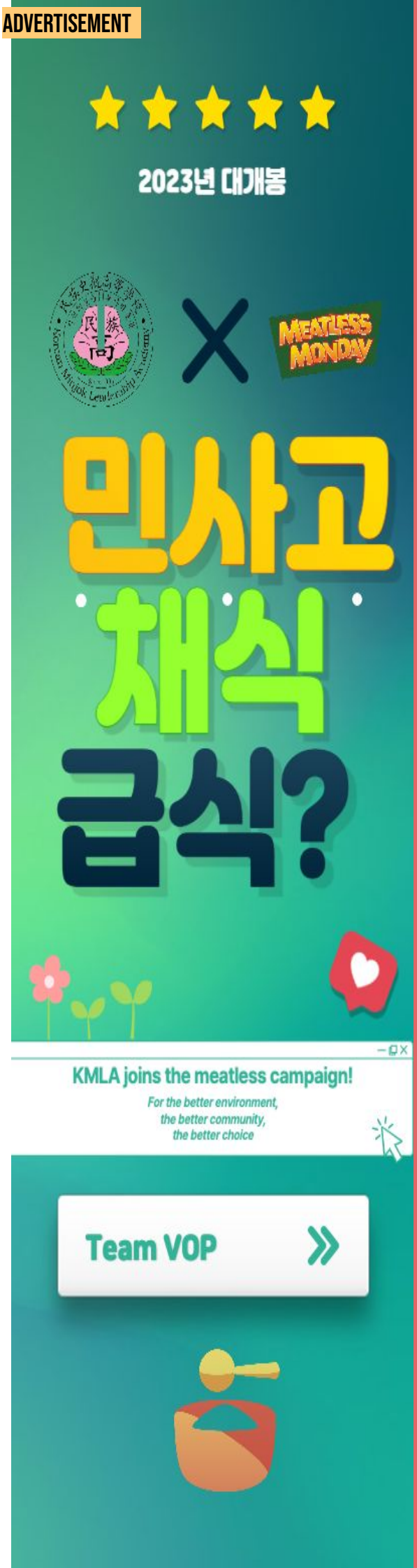
I want us to be more outspoken, to be confident, and say what we have to say. Trust that what we have to say is important enough, and speak up in class, speak up in meetings, and you'll find that a lot of the time what you have to say is important and people will listen to you.

Do you have any advice to give to the KMLA students who seek to become consultants?
I would say consulting is a great stepping stone.
For me, consulting was a great way for me to learn a lot of skills very quickly like after two years also managing someone and that like never happens in any other industry. So if you want to learn things about business really quickly and grow really quickly consulting is a great way to get into it. But also think of your time in consulting as a way to think about where you want to grow further.
Anyways, I think what you need to care about is what you are actually passionate about because that will be your base and you will build all these other practical things on top of it.

> "I WANT US TO BE MORE OUTSPOKEN, TO BE CONFIDENT, AND SAY WHAT WE HAVE TO SAY. . . YOU'LL FIND THAT A LOT OF THE TIME WHAT YOU HAVE TO SAY IS IMPORTANT AND PEOPLE WILL LISTEN TO YOU."
>
> 8TH WAVER, AMY RYU

Senior Writer
Moon Chae-Hyeon

ADVERTISEMENT



CHALLENGE ACCEPTED ! NEUROSCIENCE FOR THE PROOF OF ORIENTAL SCIENCE

AN INTERVIEW WITH 6TH WAVER, PROFESSOR NAM MIN-HO



Professor Nam-Minho is a leading alumnus who has been pioneering both oriental and western science by fusing the two with brain science. His insightful story would certainly be informative and helpful for students who wish to engage in medical sciences and expand their views on career paths. KMLA students, what kind of story would you like to deliver to our future generations?

This is an interview with Professor and researcher Nam Min-ho, currently researching the pathology of brain disorders and the mechanisms of acupuncture. He is a 6th waver of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy. Throughout the interview, he will share about his field of study and how life in KMLA affected him until now.

Please briefly introduce yourself.
Hello, I am Nam Min-ho. I am a 6th waver graduate of the Natural Sciences field in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy. Currently as a senior researcher at the Korea Institute of Technology(KIST) Brain Science Research Center, I'm conducting research on brain science, leading the "Nam Lab for Glia and Neuroinflammation (http://nam-lab.org)".

Please introduce what you are currently doing in your field.
My team is researching to uncover the mechanisms of several brain disorders that have not yet been treated, mainly researching the role of astrocytes. In addition, the mechanism of oriental acupuncture treatment is being studied neurologically. We are studying the molecular, cellular, and neural circuit-level mechanisms of various effects of acupuncture treatment that are clinically effective but have not been scientifically explained for their effectiveness.

What drove you to start this job? What triggered you to be a professional researcher in this field?
The main reason I decided to major in oriental medicine rather than western medicine was that there were still more unknown areas for research. However, I witnessed some neglection on oriental medicine just because it lacked scientific mechanisms, unlike western medicine. Therefore, I thought that more research on the scientific mechanism of oriental medicine was necessary. I targeted my research field as brain, which is safe to say that it is the last unknown area in the human body. During my Ph.D., I majored in brain science and studied astrocytes. After undergoing a doctoral program and being a postdoctoral researcher, in 2020, I was able to set up a laboratory at KIST, where I am currently working, and I have started this work in earnest.

What kind of studies or activities in KMLA influenced the 'current you?'
When I was attending KMLA, my dream was to become an astronomer. Though I was immersed in astronomy, I chose the medical field as a major at last. Still, the habit of studying voluntarily and freely in KMLA and the thirst to become a scientist seem to be the driving forces that eventually drew me back to the path of science and research. Dreams can always change, but I think the passion and voluntary motivation that I had in KMLA are still important now.

As a researcher, you've published several research papers in renowned academic journals. As a researcher in science, would you mind sharing the difficulties and the worthwhile aspects of writing an academic journal?
As you said, I am a rookie scientist who is actively carrying out research about brain. Yes, I have published more than 30 papers, including '*Cell Reports*' —which is a sister journal of *'Cell'* —and '*Current Biology*.' Even now, I am submitting my papers to several prominent journals.

Doing research requires persistence and a heart that is not afraid of failure. Discovering something new sometimes requires a lot of courage as you have to reverse what others have already argued. Only those who have experienced how stressful writing a thesis is can get the thrill of achieving the result that your hypothesis is correct in that way.

After a thesis is created, it must be submitted to an academic journal. However, this process is not easy since peer scientists who are competitors in the same research field review and evaluate my thesis. After the tough process, other researchers cite my thesis and refer to it in their experiments. This gives me the feel the joy of adding the smallest step to the progress of knowledge.

What is your advice for the KMLAians who wish to pursue a career in western medicine, oriental medicine, as well as brain science, especially in neuroscience?
I think many students want to major in the medical field. To become a true doctor, you must have the heart of "仁," which is to feel compassion for people. In addition to studying hard, I think it is worth a shot to try to cultivate the mind of "仁".

For juniors who want to major in medical science, I recommend those to take a look at their original intentions of majoring in the field. Fusion with other fields and medical sciences can become a source of inspiration for new, brilliant research. What's more, these days, scientists with medical licenses (MD-PhDs) are very welcome. This is because many studies link clinical and basic life sciences, so I would like to say that this is also a very promising path.

What I want to tell you more than anything else is that your dreams can change depending on the circumstances you are in, but don't forget that every moment of your dream is the driving force that moves you forward. I hope you always do your best in the present and dream of a flexible future.

Junior Writer
Lee Yena

ADVERTISEMENT



DREAMS. SKILLS. AND A PROFESSOR.

AN INTERVIEW WITH 1ST WAVER, PROFESSOR CHONG, FROM TEXAS TECH UNIVERSITY

Have you ever wondered about becoming a professor in a foreign country? What does it mean to become a professor? A profession where one can teach and research at the same time sounds like a perfect combination. However, would the reality of becoming a professor, the master of your field, truly make you happy?

This is an interview with Professor Chong from Texas Tech University. He currently lives in the United States of America, after graduating from high school and college in South Korea. He is a first waver of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy. He now researches and teaches students about biomedical technology.

Can you please introduce yourself?
Hello. My name is Chong Jo Woon and I am a professor at Texas Tech University.

Can you briefly introduce your life journey (the process of becoming a professor at Texas Tech University)?
I am one of the first waver of KMLA, went to Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST), and majored in Electronic and Electrical Engineering. I did all of my Master's and Ph.D. at KAIST. I went to the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) for two and a half years and studied biomedical engineering for the first time at MIT. After graduating, I was hired by Worcester Polytechnic Institute as a research assistant professor and also worked as an adjunct teaching professor at the University of Connecticut. I won the spotlight after being acknowledged with the best paper about biomedical engineering. Now I've become a tenured professor at Texas Tech University.

How did you decide to become a professor?
I did not expect myself to become a professor until I was doing my Master's and Ph.D. When I was at MIT doing research, that's when I first dreamed of becoming a professor. At that time, I was actually in a good state with Google almost hiring me. However, if I am at a certain company I have to do the company's projects, not what I want to research. I think that the tremendous benefit that a professor has is the freedom of being able to research what they want to. I feel like this is needed for society.

Many students want to become university professors. What is the process of becoming a professor in the U.S.?
In the case of America, compared to Korea they look at who you are deep. Instead of the school that you graduated from, they focus on who you are and what you can achieve. After the resumés and short interview, you will get a call from the university to come and meet them for about 3 days. During those 3 days, you stay at a hotel and meet all of the professors working in that faculty. Also, you have to hold a research seminar about your past research and the plan that you have. After 3 days, the professors that you met, which is the entire faculty, will vote on whether to accept you or not. When you become a research professor, the university gives you 5 years to prove yourself. During the 5 years that you are hired for a tenured track, the university looks at whether or not you can survive. If you can prove yourself in the 5 years given, you become hired as a tenured professor.

What is your daily routine as a professor?
The most important part of the day is when I wake up. During the morning, I always try to find a time when I can write something. As a professor, we mainly do two things. The first is doing research and the other is teaching. In my case, research is the priority. So, I usually write at least a paragraph or half a page on the algorithm research that I am doing. I usually write from around 7 am to 10 am. Then I communicate with the students during the other part of my morning and talk about the research projects that are going on. From 1 pm to 5 pm I usually have meetings and think about new ideas. After 5 pm, which is my favorite part of the day, I go back home and enjoy my life.

What is the best part of your job?
I think social causes are really important in life. My job is the best fit to achieve social causes. Through my job, I can reduce the rate of disease and increase public health. I enjoy the way that the field that I like is combined with social causes and achieves humanity's goal.

Also, there are lots of chances to travel abroad. Normally, lots of seminars and forums are held at vacation spots. You receive money for those forums and seminars, so the business trips that we go on are normally really exciting. We tend to go at least twice a year, so it's as if you go on holiday at least twice a year abroad.

What kind of skills are needed to become a professor of medical engineering?
I think this goes for all kinds of academic fields. The ability to focus on one thing and truly be immersed in that field is important. If you are in the state of not being able to listen to anything because you are so into something, then that field is the field that you have to go for.

What do you recommend doing to achieve a dream?
I knew what my curiosity was ever since I was in high school. I think it is important to know what you truly love and what you are curious about. Thus, I recommend going everywhere, looking around the world, and finding out what you would be willing to do for the rest of your life.

You lived a life that many people can only dream about. What are your tips for achieving things that seem impossible?
When we are on our journey of life, sometimes we wonder whether the path that we are going on is right. We can also think that perhaps we can go the other way. There is always a path that the majority takes, but I do not believe that that specific path is the answer for everyone. We can still succeed without going on the same path that everyone else goes. If there is something that you want to do, think about your plans, and your ideas, double-check it, and just go for it. Do not think about it 10 times; just think about it twice and go. You will not regret the decisions that you made.

To end our interview, what are the last words that you want to say to students in KMLA?
There could be lots of different situations or scenarios that you might not be able to understand in life. However, in the majority of cases, you will be able to understand if you truly try to, and we can learn through understanding those situations.



CHONG JO-WOON, FIRST WAVER

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01 THE PERMISSIBLE RANGE OF ACCESSORIES

It might be unfamiliar to the current KMLAians, especially 27th wavers, that just a year ago, it was forbidden to wear a ring or have their hair permed. According to teacher Mira Jung, there had always been hardship in guiding students to follow the regulation about appearance because students had been throwing doubts against the regulation. A lot of students in KMLA had been wearing earrings, putting makeup on, or changing their hair styles in their middle school without particular regulation. Therefore, most of them couldn't simply accept the regulation.

However, some teachers also had no appropriateness about the regulation, too. When Mrs. Jung was working in a regular highschool, the appearance regulation existed to make a division of students in unexpected events or accidents.

KMLA is an entire boarding school and students cannot visit outside usually, thus, the appearance is not actually related to study. She said that there were many teachers who also thought that guiding and punishing students with their appearance has improper aspects besides the reasons about neat and formal outfit.

They thought that the regulation should be relaxed.

With all these KMLA family's desires and 32th legislative council's effort, the regulation is now relaxed. Now, in school regulations, the content is mentioned as "*Hair and appearance shall guarantee the freedom of individual students, but the detailed regulations of the Student Council shall apply.*"

By this significant change, now students can wear almost all types of rings (which are hung tightly on skin, not dangerously). except piercings which can physically threaten students. Also, the changes in hairstyle is unrestricted except for hair dying which can have negative physical effects against students. Through the teachers' deliberation and students' strong will and action, we could achieve freedom.

A 26th waver, Hwai Kwon said, " By the relaxed regulation, the students became able to express themselves with less sense of guilt, because even before the relaxation of the regulation, most students had done the same things in silence. Also, more students started to try the earrings and get their hair permed." As students, it is positive that the relaxed regulation opened us a chance to express ourselves without doubts. We should be thankful for the great reformation!

THE CULTURES OF KMLA ONCE UPON A TIME

IN ITS 28 YEARS OF HISTORY, KMLA HAS BEEN THROUGH NUMEROUS CHANGES. THE STUDENTS NOW HAVE ACCESS TO PLENTY OF NICE FACILITIES AND ARE SUBJECT TO STUDENT-FRIENDLY POLICIES, NOT KNOWING PREVIOUS TRADITIONS WHICH HAVE FADED OUT TO THE PAST. SOME OF THOSE, SUCH AS A UTILITY ROOM WITH A MICROWAVE OVEN AND A REFRIGERATOR OUGHT TO ATTRACT THE KMLA STUDENTS' ATTENTION HAD IT BEEN HERE NOW. AND HERE ARE THE CULTURES OF KMLA ONCE UPON A TIME, TOLD BY THE TEACHERS, ALUMNI, AND STUDENTS.

Many years ago, when there weren't many students in KMLA like now, there used to be refrigerators and microwave ovens in empty rooms in the dormitory.

She said that she can remember that the students used to hang out in the room chatting with each other or eating snacks. Now it is unrealizable because Dukgo, our dormitory, is accommodating its maximum students. Therefore, there isn't any spare room to be used as the utility room. Misses Jung mentioned that our school is trying to remodel and supplement school facilities instead of those utility rooms.

In this case, the students might feel unfortunate about losing the old facility. A lot of students crave a refrigerator and a microwave oven to enjoy various snacks in the dormitory. According to an interview with Hwang Sohee teacher, more than a decade ago, when the 10th wavers were enrolled in the school, there used to be utility rooms on a few floors of the dormitory, including the 8th floor. In a small utility room, there used to be a refrigerator and a microwave oven. Students didn't need to go up to the school cafeteria to put their snacks or medicine in the refrigerator. (Misses Hwang expects us to bear the fact in our mind that despite the existence of these utility rooms, the students enjoyed the school meal from the school cafeteria.)

Meanwhile, she was a student then so teacher Mira Jung provided more information about the utility room.

These are two interesting cases of the old of KMLA that have disappeared into history. Current students in KMLA don't know well about these old cultures that used to exist. In some cases, the changes were optimistic and sometimes, those were too bad as current students' perspective. Looking back to the old school policies is not only interesting but also could function as a nice guideline to build an advanced KMLA society for the students. Also, it might give us a nice opportunity to communicate with the alumni and teachers!



Junior Writer

Eom Seah

02 A UTILITY ROOM WITH A MICROWAVE OVEN & A REFRIGERATOR

1. WHAT IS THE ALUMNI CULTURE OR KMLA CULTURE THAT YOU REMEMBER WHEN YOU WERE IN KMLA?

2. HOW DO YOU LIVE OR CONTACT OTHER GRADUATES OF KMLA?

Busy lives, still close friends
10th Waver, Hwang So-Hee

1. I remember a lot of my time with my friends, like having lunch and coming down to my room and eating sweets together. There was something like a box of sweets in our room that had all the stuff in it. I took out one of my favorites from there, forgot about it, and talked about it and that. Having lived in a dormitory, I think I was as friendly as family. When I graduated, it was hard to experience that relationship again, so I still think about it.

2. I keep in touch with my motives, but like everyone in their early to mid-30s, it's a busy time with their work, and my motives are getting married and having a baby, and that's the time, so when there are big events like that, I have been in touch for a long time, celebrating, and so on. And even if it's not necessarily a motive, KMLAians are people who share a similar experience, so even if they are not friendly, they may feel more friendly when they meet in society.

Still close friends through Social Media
17th Waver, Hannah Chu

1. It's not a recognized "culture" per se, but being able to make random jokes and let loose in front of friends. Living in dorms, I think, not only helped me with self-discipline but the faculty to be imperfect and messy and sometimes embarrassing in front of others, which are inevitable when you coexist as human beings.

2. On the one hand, it's difficult because International Field students have gone on to live all over the world. On the other, I think I was one of those people who resisted being the kind of college kid who only hangs out with people from their own country. But looking back now I do wish I had put more intention and effort into maintaining the KMLA community. Technology is a great thing - a few friends and I get to see each other's lives on social media. Also, it helps to be based in New York since people often travel there for pleasure or work.

Alumni active schools in the U.S.
18th Waver, Will Hwang

1. Looking back, I liked classes, grades, clubs, hobbies, and so on. Without any restrictions, anyone could come and enjoy it.

2. When you first enter an American university, it is more difficult than you think to adapt to the new environment, so you are likely to get help from Koreans, especially KMLA seniors, a lot. In particular, I think emotional bonds are very important. U.S. universities have nicer career choices and a wider variety of opportunities than Korea, so intelligence is important, and if you don't have an emotional bond with your seniors, you'll miss out on the opportunity to get good information. That's why U-Chicago creates a KMLA meeting every semester where about 8 graduates spend time together.

When I was in the 1st grade, the 14th seniors took the lead, and when I was in the 4th grade, there were 23rd graders in the 1st grade. Based on my experience, I can be confident that U-Chicago is one of the most alumni active schools in the United States. But the reality is that when you go to school, it's hard to interact unless you're in the same school.



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ALUMNI CULTURE & INTERACTION

What do you think you will be doing when you graduate? Some may think about their university fantasies (such as dating) but most will probably say "I don't know." Today, we have brought some classic, valuable advice that may help those who can barely picture their vague futures. Let's see what our graduates have gone through when they were in KMLA and how they are currently interacting with other graduates!

It was outstanding to listen to the various experiences of our great graduates! To recall what our graduates answered, most of them are still connected with their KMLA colleagues. However, when it comes to which field they are in, they differ in how they contact each other, especially those in the International Field. Normally, alumni in the city, limited to San Fran/New York/Chicago/Boston arranged a meeting, and it was interesting that a typical union of KMLA graduates was activated in the University of Chicago. Nevertheless, some graduates had less contact with others, but still, they had their messengers to anytime freely contact others. As for the Minjok field, some graduates are still in daily contact with their colleagues!

Maybe, since graduates in Korea are closer to each other, they have more chances to keep in touch with others. In either field, it was clear that they were still contacting their colleagues, having fun with one another, and helping each other. In general, they all had contact with KMLA graduates even though they were having busy lives.

Just wait for a couple of years, and we will all become active leaders throughout society. And at that moment, maybe the bond between KMLA colleagues will turn into a valuable gift for everyone. I hope you can all make good memories, just as our graduates have, and enjoy a joyful life with your loving friends of KMLA!

I think it was especially because of the coronavirus. I think it's the end of the call or when I'm on a trip and seeing it once or twice. When I graduate and get a seat, I get a meeting with my colleagues in the city, which is limited to San Fran/New York/Chicago/Boston. Originally, before Corona, we had a reunion in Korea in the summer, but we were told it was going to resume this year.

Great colleagues as a great friend
21st Waver, Kang Ji-Hoon

1. I think the activities are the most memorable thing I did in the club! I've worked hard to be part of the *English Debate Society*(EDS), but I'm still in frequent contact with *English Debate Society*(EDS) motives, eating, and eating (I think I'm connected to question 2). I still remember going on a vision trip after that, but I was a little sad to hear recently that my juniors cannot beat the beat due to the coronavirus outbreak.

2. Yes, I contact my colleagues very often and I meet often. I think I see them almost every day, especially with my friends who went to the same college, and I think I see them at least once a month or two, even if the school is different from my close friends!

I think it's a deeper, longer-lasting relationship as much as friends who have had a hard time together! It's a little hard to generalize, but I think the vast majority of KMLA graduates probably see and stay in touch with each other often after graduation!

Getting help from seniors
23rd Waver Lee Deok-Haeng

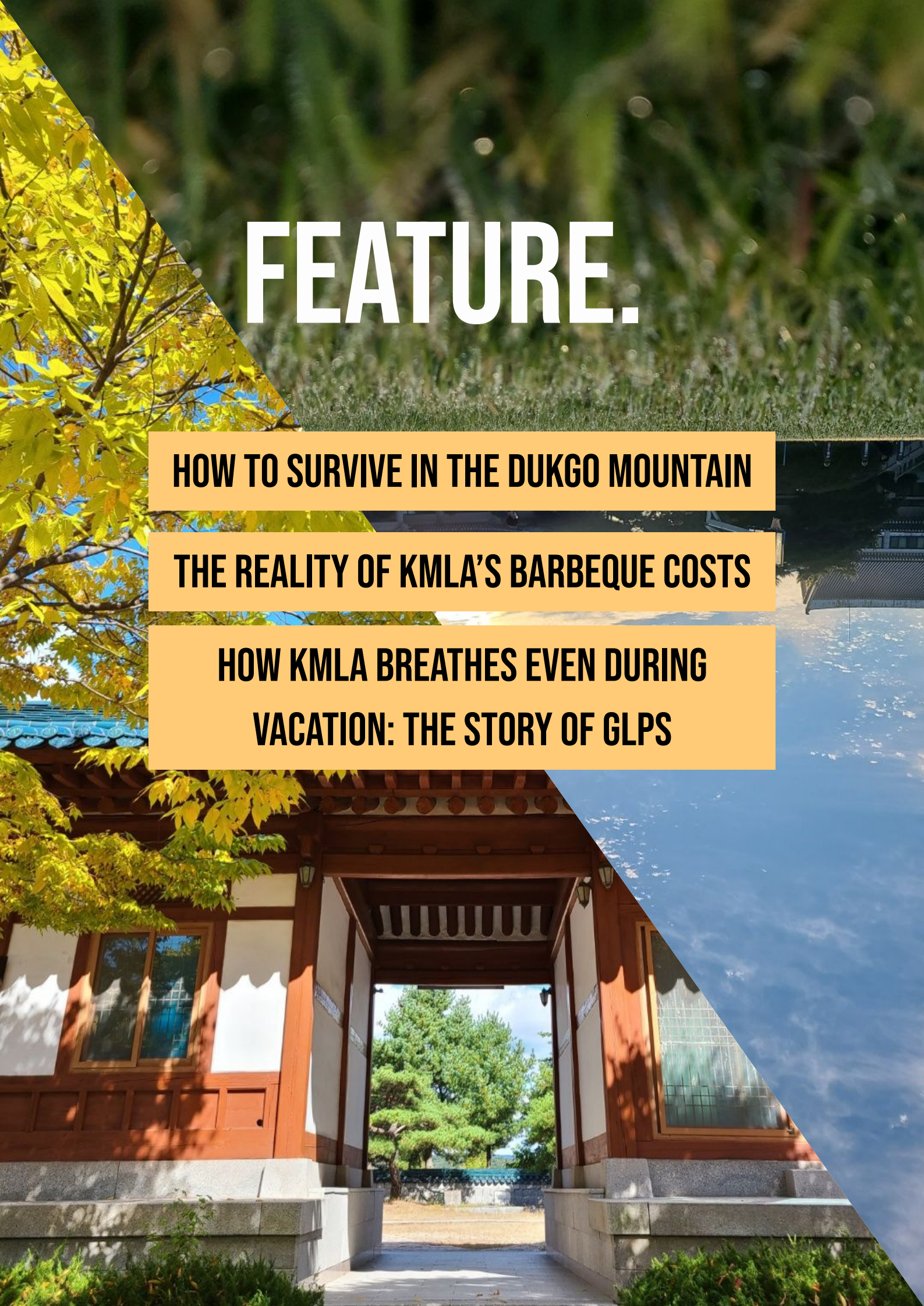
1. I think the most memorable thing is of course there are a lot of little things - I think I had a lot of fun playing with my friends while I was on a field trip and living in a dormitory in 3rd grade. It was a lot of fun to create my club and work on the activity. I started a *Rest In Philosophy*(RIP) with friends who liked to talk philosophically or think deeply, and I talked a lot about life with like-minded people.

2. I'm in an international field, so I think it's more so, but I'm still very close to my international classmates, even in the U.S., with regular video calls! When I look at the KMLA seniors who have a working or social life in the United States after graduating from college, I think I see a lot of people who are close to the motives. In addition to motivation, I think I get a lot of help from the alumni network. Many alumni are active in various aspects, and when they are looking for career counseling or opportunities, they are often happy to ask the seniors of KMLA to help. I had a lot of help from the seniors when deciding which university to go to, and I am doing an internship in Korea this summer, something that the 5th waver has allowed me to do. As such, I think it would be a good idea to actively ask the Senior Network for help if they have something or an opportunity that interests them!



Junior Writer
Oh Seungchan

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FEATURE.

HOW TO SURVIVE IN THE DUKGO MOUNTAIN

THE REALITY OF KMLA'S BARBEQUE COSTS

HOW KMLA BREATHES EVEN DURING VACATION: THE STORY OF GLPS

Light slowly comes into your eyes, and you wake up.
Expecting the texture of your soft blanket, you turn your head right and start to cough severely due to the dirt that went inside your mouth. Noticing something's wrong, you set your body upright and spit out the dirt inside your mouth, and look around frantically. What you see is the green forest, with tall, huge trees.
You're in the middle of the Dukgo Mountain.

HOW TO SURVIVE IN THE DUKGO MOUNTAIN

You don't have any idea why you woke up there, but because it seems that you are deep inside the mountain, and you don't know the way out, you think that you should spend at least a few days there to find the way out. At first it seemed incertain and hopeless, however, you reached the thought that you had pretty much interest in nature, so you have much knowledge about what to do to survive in nature.

You now have some confidence and started moving to gather food. You are planning to collect fruits, and then hunt animals. Because fruits provide you both nutrients and water, it is very important for you to collect them. You wander around the mountain and notice some edible fruits. There are red berries named *Schisandra*, Korean cherries named *Prunus tomentosa*, and the Japanese bramble, also known as Australian raspberry. You collect them as much as you can, put them inside your pockets, and then excitedly move to search for some animals that you can hunt.



As you move around, you see some animals such as small wild swines, water deer, and korean hare moving at a far distance. You first thought to chase them and catch them, but later remembered that they were very fast for you to catch by your bare hands. Therefore, you plan to make a trap by making the frame with thick tree branches and tieing them together by using vines. You at last made the trap, buried it in the ground slightly to make the animals hard to notice it, and successfully caught two hares and one swine. Now you collected a few flints and made fire, and then ate the roasted animals you caught.

Full and happy, now you feel thirsty and want to drink water. The water you gained from the fruits weren't enough. Now you see small streams, and you walk towards them, but suddenly realized although you can gain water from the small flowing waters, it is not safe enough. Stream water is most likely infested with small microorganisms such as microparasites, and they might cause rashes, allergic reactions, and at worst serious diseases such as malaria. Knowing the riskiness of drinking straight from the stream, you now try to come up another way to gain water. While you are thinking, it starts to rain suddenly, and you are delighted and decide to drink it after collecting it inside the plastic bag which was inside your pocket. Because you know the fact that although rainwater might contain some dust, they do not contain microorganisms, you drink the water comfortably.

Now, since some time has passed since it started to rain, you slightly feel cold, and need a place to dry your wet clothes. After thinking for a solution, you decide to build a small hut with tree branches, rocks, and vines. You cutted tree branches with the sharp rocks that you found, and connected them together by tying them together with vine. After spending a lot of time and effort until the sky became dark, you finally completed building the hut.

When you went in the hut to dry yourself and take a rest, you sense that something popped up at the corner of the hut. You turn on your flashlight, and recognize that something was a small frog. At first you tried to catch the frog with your hands and put him outside the hut. However, after you see its stomach, you change your thoughts. The frog's stomach color was orange, which meant that it was toxic with high potential. The color red or orange is the warning of the nature that tells us that the animal is poisonous. You knew that, so you eventually didn't touch the frog with your bare hands, but pushed it out of the hut with a tree branch.

Because you had lots of knowledge about how to survive in the nature, you were able to escape the mountains successfully after a few days. These were the tips that could be helpful to survive in the mountain of KMLA. Although you will most likely experience, or have such experience at reality, I hope you enjoyed imagining the situation in which you have to survive in the mountains. Maybe keep in mind some of the tips, just in case.

Junior Writer
Lee Jeongmin

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THE *REALITY* OF KMLA'S BARBEQUE COSTS

Barbecue is a special event for KMLA students to create heart-warming memories of encouraging group spirit and having delicious foods. Enjoying freshly grilled meat with beloved friends and teachers is precious time of leisure in the hectic school schedule. But what if there is an unseen absurdity in the materials used for barbecue?

There has been a rumor about the difference in barbecue costs between the school's two food providers: *Hanaro*-mart and D-mart. Lee Yoonho, who is famous as a 26th waver gourmand, explained that from his many barbecue experiences, D-mart turns out to be charging more for meat products. He said, "When our barbecue team used *Hanaro*-mart, it cost around 13,000 won to 15,000 won per person. But, when we ordered from D-mart, we paid about 20,000 won per student. I assume that the source of the cost difference is meat." While it is evident that D-mart claims more expensive bills, the origins of high costs are undiscovered. Another 26th waver food expert, Kim Soo-young, told that he received higher costs for tools from D-mart. "I remember that in D-mart, it cost about 160,000 won aside from the meat price. This means D-mart has expensive tools and side dishes." Observing agreements from the raised suspicions, Minjok Herald decided to investigate the truth.

The analysis is based on 20 barbecue receipts, with 4 from D-mart and 16 from *Hanaro*-mart, and half printed in 2021. Although D-mart was introduced in November 2021, evidence shows that students still prefer to use *Hanaro*-mart. The bills were randomly collected from the head students of each barbecue team. After comparing the prices for each product, significant price discrepancies for coal and meat were discovered.

For coal, *Hanaro*-mart supplied *Yet-gol cham* and *Gama-gol Cham-namu* which are each 11,900₩ per 3kg and 4,400₩ per 1kg. D-mart sold Holiday coal which is 5,400₩ per 2kg. D-mart had the lowest price per kg: 2,700₩. D-mart was initially suspected of high prices for tools, but the result of the coal price comparison indicates that *Hanaro*-mart has more expensive coal. Expenses for other supplements were almost identical, considering the price fluctuation between 2021 and 2022.

On the other hand, the analysis of meat prices confirmed the doubts about the higher costs of D-mart. 25th waver, Seo Yoon-myeong, said that he was surprised by the price increase when he purchased from D-mart in 2022, compared to his purchase through *Hanaro*-mart in 2021. His experience proved to be right. In terms of *Hanaro*-mart, beef, pork belly, and pork shoulder were 10,500₩, 6,000₩, and 6,600₩ per 300g respectively. *Hanaro*-mart specified the price per 300g and summed the total price by multiplying the number of 300g packages in the order. In contrast, D-mart charged the total price of meat without clarifying the price per package. Therefore, the price per serving had to be estimated by Minjok Herald for each barbecue. There were inconsistencies in the price per package for D-mart. Pork belly cost 11,005₩, 9,436.36₩, and 10,028 ₩ for different barbecue days. The pork shoulder was 8,932.5₩ and 10,387.27₩.

The analysis revealed a notable disparity between the prices of the two agents. Pork belly only cost 6,000₩ when ordered from *Hanaro*-mart, but it was 11,005₩ at maximum when bought from D-mart. The pork shoulder was 6,600₩ in *Hanaro*-mart but about 10,387.27₩ in D-mart. On average, meat was *about 3,600₩ more expensive in D-mart.*

	HANARO-MART	D-MART
COAL(1KG)	*Yet-gol cham*: 3,966₩ *Gama-gol Cham-Namu*: 4,400₩	Holiday: 2,700₩
PORK BELLY (300G)	6,000₩	10,156₩ (Average)
PORK SHOULDER (300G)	6,600₩	9,659.5 ₩(Average)

In the risen suspicion about the higher price in D-mart, there were conflicting presumptions about the source of the price gap: the meat products or the supplements. The result of the investigation clarifies that the high price originates from the meat products in D-mart that is 3,600₩ more expensive. Although coal prices were about 1,483₩ higher in *Hanaro*-mart, the fact that a typical barbecue team buys a greater amount of meat than coal and the bigger price gap for meat make the total price from D-mart discernibly expensive. The reality of the barbecue cost is that *D-mart typically charges higher prices for meat*.

In November 2021, D-mart was introduced to the official barbecue agent contract to cope with the lack of transparency on the meat prices of the original agent, *Hanaro*-mart. *Hanaro*-mart handwrites the prices of meat products instead of providing a printed receipt, which had been questioned of prudent source. D-mart was chosen as an alternative, but charged a much more expensive price. This can be seen as a conspiracy considering the value of barbecue in KMLA. However, the higher prices don't imply that D-mart charges unreasonable prices intended to benefit the business owner. Further investigation on the quality of meat and source of meat (whether it is from wholesale or retail) should be conducted to evaluate the legitimacy of the prices.

For the barbecue to be conducted without worries, KMLA staffs should keep in track of price changes and resolve the questions. *Minjok Herlad* gives supports for a warmer and happier barbecue!

Senior Writer
Jeon Seoyoung

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HOW KMLA BREATHES EVEN DURING VACATION: THE STORY OF *GLPS*

The name 'GLPS' is not unfamiliar to us KMLAians. In fact, many of us have participated in these official summer and winter camps as young and hopeful candidates of KMLA. Yoo Da-Eun, the previous Head TA of the 2022 winter GLPS recalls the hectic day in the life at GLPS.

"After a long break of GLPS due to the pandemic, the second online GLPS was held in January 2022. All students stayed at home on Zoom, but 7 TAs and 6 teachers, including Mr. Ganse and Mr. Baumgardner, were on campus.
TA's and teachers were assigned to an office in the English building. After a good night's sleep in the dormitory (or the family building), we had to arrive at our office at 8:45. At 9:00, class for 7th and 8th grade students starts. Each TA and student logs into the breakout room in Zoom and starts class. The classes are 2 hours each, and the student has 4 hours of class every day. After the first four periods finish, we all move to the 12th floor of the dormitory and have lunch. Then, the second half of the day starts with the 5th and 6th grade students and the day ends. When TAs don't have class, they can have some rest or have free time, but they must write letters to parents for each student every week, so usually TAs use their free time to write letters. After dinner, we have free time in the dormitory, but one special part is that TA's had *honjeong* during the GLPS at 9:00."

This is GLPS in a nutshell, which many students might not even know of. But even after learning about the schedule and programs of GLPS, you can't really say that you *know* GLPS. GLPS is much more than just a school camp. Today, we tell the story of KMLA's one and only camp.

GLPS stands for Global Leadership Program for Students, which is exactly what it tries to implement. Starting from 2004, the camp has been hosted almost every summer and winter vacation, with the exception of canceled or online camps during the COVID-19 pandemic. This may be the reason why GLPS feels so distant to us 25th, 26th, and 27th wavers. However, we have and will again be cleaning out our rooms in order to host curious elementary and middle schoolers, and some of us will become a part of this historical camp as Teaching Assistants or even Program Assistants after graduation. Despite the truth that many students are skeptical about dedicating an entire vacation to a camp that seems to have little relevance to them, it is likely that a little bit of knowledge gained about GLPS will bring its importance into focus.

To get an idea of what has and will take place in our dorm rooms and classrooms during summer and winter, we conducted an interview with Mr. Ganse, the program director of GLPS. We began with the history of the camp itself, which embodies the camp's spirit and growth.

Could you tell us about the brief history of GLPS? When did GLPS start and why, and how did it go?
Until 2004, the school and the milk factory were one and there really wasn't any legal separation between the two. So in this school business plan, a certain percentage of the revenue had been planned to come from the milk factory, and the moment they sold it that no longer came, so they needed more money.
And they had two camps at the time. One was GLPS and the other one was rented out to some outside school. They used our building, advertised under the name KMLA. That camp died within one year, and our camp achieved the recognition it should achieve.
I can tell you in 2004, I had to learn how to run a camp, and I had to learn it by doing. Now in the first camp, almost everything which could go wrong went wrong. I guided that camp one day at a time, focusing on the problem which had to be solved today.
in these rooms.
And on the last day when we had the drama performances in the auditorium, I thought to myself, 'it's only three more performances and then the camp is over'. Then I realized that I would survive that camp.
And it was such a big learning moment for me. What I learned was everything that went wrong, and I tried to prevent that thing from going wrong the next time by planning properly.
In the first camps, we got full camps because the name of KMLA is great. But by camp number 7 we had about 30 empty seats, and that meant the name of the school alone was not enough. So by that time, Mr. Eom was director and I was called program director. And so Mr. Eom and myself talked about the situation - what can we do the next time around? And I said we should have fewer classes but more detailed classes. And we must be different from the other camps so we should start writing our own books. So I had one teacher I knew who studied biology at college, and I said don't focus on the entire science, pick some aspect out and write a booklet about it. I would do one on history. We also had debate classes with level three debate, and level two debate, so we gave structure to that program.
And by now camp was just our camp, not copying what others were doing. So the kids who came home from the camp were changed because they became more independent in their working style. I want students to become more independent and more proactive. But you really have students who come from a school where they are showered with information all the time and memorizing, and they came back and they got a completely new feeling of what studying can be, and many of them decide there's one school in Korea I want to apply for, and that's this one. We didn't start out with the philosophy we have now, but over time we changed.

We heard that you've been dedicating almost all of your breaks to GLPS. Is there a special reason for that?
If I don't, there's no GLPS.
Number one, when we started - I don't know who, but somebody - told me we only do it for the money, don't put too much effort into it. If I would have done that, GLPS would have ended a few years after we started, and the school might not be here anymore.
Now at the same time, GLPS is perhaps my life's work. In the beginning, it was something I didn't really identify with that much because you just had to get the show through. But when I made it mine, and Wayne is a part of that—so -- when Wayne and myself made this camp our camp, it became a true project and we identified with it more and more.
My last regular vacation was in 2003. This year, I think school ended about a week before camp started. A week, for me, paradise! So that's rare. The last couple of years, normally camp ended on a Saturday and school ended on Wednesday or Thursday. Yeah, so basically I had no time. So for instance, if I wanted to see my family I would have my family come over. I could not attend the wedding of my daughter or the christening of my grandson.
At one camp there was something like a teacher's workshop. It was one in Seoul and I think I attended those courses for four days, and then I came back and out of the car and into running the show, and had to tell everybody you have to prepare for this this way and that way, and so on. And this camp did not burn down, although I wasn't here for three or four days I was kind of concerned about it all the time.
Camp is not just there when you have the 3 weeks of camp. You need to prepare it from the day one camp is over, until the next one. And that's basically what I do outside of the time I spend with my regular classes.

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HOW KMLA BREATHES EVEN DURING VACATION: THE STORY OF *GLPS*

How has it been working with students as PAs and TAs, not as students that you teach?

One thing is, they learn to see this entire education system from the other side. You see this kid five years younger than you who goes through the same experience you have. So what happens is many PAs and TAs have specific groups they're assigned to and in the evening they sit down together and the PAs and TAs give some kinds of tips and advice.

There was this one kid who had this grand hypothesis for an elementary school student to come up with. He probably has had some discussion with the PA or TA who didn't tell him that but tried to get him to get that idea. The idea is that at camp students have role models in front of them and they're TAs and PAs.

Now we changed camp in a way: two debates a week, one presentation a week, the way we would like to teach. But as we have teachers from the outside, they have to get into that. But, the best students in my class, they know what I want, they know how I teach, they know how the GLPS classes work. So I had to trust nonprofessionals to teach classes the way I want them to be taught, and I had TAs who were better prepared for that than the teachers. So if I have a total newcomer as a teacher, I put my best TA into that class, and I don't have to worry about that class.

Maybe in the other courses, they know how to answer more multiple-choice questions, but I try to do a more thorough my job in trying to get students to interpret sources on their own.

So camp is also kind of an extension of myself. Because we have entire programs that teach history the way I want to teach it and teach nature observation the way I want to teach it.

What would be your favorite or most memorable memory you had at GLPS?

The real best moments are when towards the end of camp you go to the computer room and you see students not wasting their time looking up some comics or so, but actually really being focused. And they want to, and they come to me and ask, "Mr. Ganse, can you explain this to me?" So the attitude you can see collectively, not in just one individual but in significant groups of students.

But another thing, there was a student who got me to change the way we run presentation contests in nature observation. He gave a comment after every presentation, constructive criticism. He destroyed a couple of presentations, and the guy was just an elementary school kid. The guy was knocking me out of my shoes. So I created a prize, an award for the best critical mind in order to give these people the recognition they deserve. So that was really something–there is a lot of talent in these kids, so give them the chance to make mistakes. Mistakes are a learning opportunity. And there were teachers who came to me and told me I had really established something really special here.

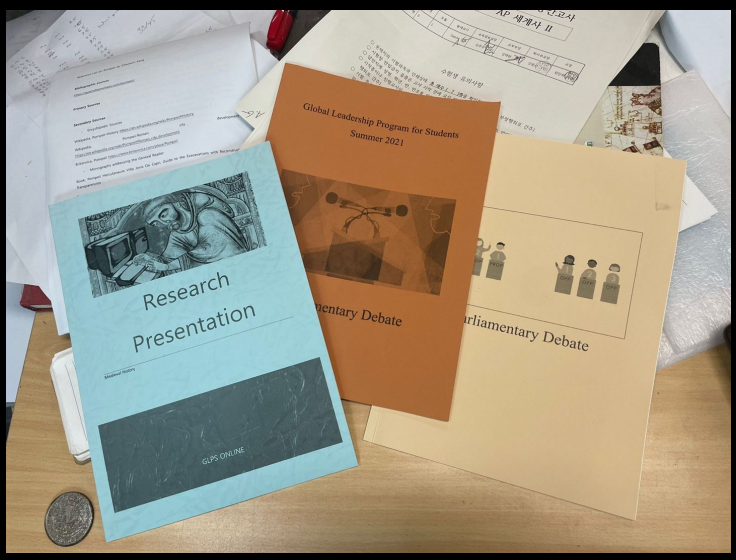
And the reason why this camp lasts so long is we had kids who came back four or five times. And the kid who came back four or five times, one of them, she was top of the class. And the parents pay real money for this, and the kid wants to have the same class again. She came back, and all that she had learned about how to present and which mistakes to avoid, she had not forgotten anything. She gives the first presentation, and scores top of the class. And the people for whom that is new have a role model to follow. Things like that. The pride of the teacher is in the performance of the student.

The camp has a very commercial history behind it. However, as it aged through the hands of passionate teachers, PAs, TAs, and participating students, it has grown to have another significant meaning: an opportunity for younger students to have a taste of KMLA's education one that is not just about memorizing and soaking up facts, but about enterprisingly seeking their own interests and academic thirst.

This is something to think about instead of dreading having to move out your luggage every vacation. Yes, it is draining and even frustrating, it may even feel awkward to have strangers living in your room. But, maybe take a moment to think about the young kids who will meet their role models in these very rooms, and maybe even grow up to become one of us KMLAians - who will get to experience the product of teachers' and students' endeavors to make education more than just checking right answers on exams. Valuable summers and winters flourish in these rooms.

Senior Writer
Chaewon Kang





>Booklets that are used during GLPS

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Inconvenient and Disabled
Juvenile Justice
Using Facebook in KMLA
Student Anonymous System inside and Outside KMLA
Ken Rhee's Ukrainian Escapade: a "Minjok" perspective

EDITORIAL.

INCONVENIENT AND DISABLED

15% of the world's population lives with some form of disability, of whom 50.5% suffer physical dysfunction. In other words, about 7.6% of the human race, or 1 in 13 *homo sapiens* selected arbitrarily from planet Earth, is handicapped physically. Although a coalition of 4.5 billion people is substantial, considering it is larger than the entire population of the United States, the disabled are rarely represented in politics. Naming a prominent disabled politician out of hundreds of powerhouses is a hefty task, most social policies do not even consider the disabled, and a gap of 5.4 percentage points exists between the disabled among adults and politicians. Underrepresentation of the disabled is a severe problem.

Society neglecting minorities is no recent phenomenon: maltreatments include racial discrimination, gender oppression, and religious extermination. To protect themselves from infringements of fundamental rights and to gain a voice in the international community, minorities have often assembled methodically throughout history; using conviction or numbers to protest against injustice through civil disobedience. Mohandas Gandhi's Salt March, The Singing Revolution, and Rosa Parks' Bus Boycott were a few among many successful examples of protest.

Whether the disabled should use this means of aggrandization is another problem. The ongoing debate can be boiled down into one supreme clash: whether legitimacy can be justified by efficacy.

Propositions for 'inconvenience' focus on one core matter: effectiveness. In the status quo, the disabled have no convenient way of voicing their opinion successfully to a large audience. Most of their peaceful campaigns, movements, and speeches do little to gain public attention. Even in the cases where they succeed at doing so, politicians simply pretend they care until the notion cools down and neglect requests to reform. Thus, 'inconvenience' is a mechanism to create prolonged attention until actual reform.

A notable precedent is a subway demonstration by SADD (Solidarity Against Disability Discrimination), the largest disabled advocacy group in South Korea. Starting this January, SADD executed guerrilla-style subway protests during the morning rush hour, demanding presidential candidates grant disabled people the rights to movement, education, labor, and deinstitutionalization.

Although they were unable to extract any promises from government officials, SADD certainly generated interest in the rights of the disabled by practically impacting the public. If they had properly recognized the mishaps in the demonstration on the 30th of June, in which a small portion of their members took over the waiting room of a train where the protest was taking place and drank through the night, their claims may have been more convincing and, thus, effective. Nevertheless, since the morning subway system was paralyzed due to the protest, and the SADD threatened to do so again until the government provided a proper address, politicians had no choice but to negotiate with their demands. The bigger the impact, the bigger the interest; thus, more chance of response. However, some might say, since this method harms innocent bystanders using the facility, isn't it fundamentally unjust?

John Rawls once said that injustice could only be tolerated to prevent an even greater injustice. Although 'inconvenience' inflicts harm upon people, the justification is this: civil disobedience is the only way for minorities to ensure their voices are heard on a national scale. The goal of 'inconvenience' is to improve life and guarantee the necessary rights of disabilities: it prevents the majority from having tyranny over the fundamental liberties of the minority. Thus, one can argue that to prevent a greater injustice, and to protect an essential aspect of rights for the minority, a temporary invasion of people's rights can be justified.

Everybody should have equal rights and opportunities without discrimination, harassment, and reprisal concerning employment, trade, self-governing profession, services, goods, contracts, and facilities. It is certainly a major problem that a group of minorities is being neglected, underrepresented, and discriminated against. Although 'inconveniences' have their limits, in the status quo, it seems the only way to make politicians and people listen. There would have been no need for pedestrians to be bothered if the society was just to every citizen in the first place. After all, as the constitution says, every person is equal under the rule of law.

Junior Writer
Park Sewoong



NETFLIX SERIES REVIEW: JUVENILE JUSTICE

Korean society is well-known for "education fever." It runs so high that many students and parents become obsessed with the identical goal of entering prestigious universities in the so-called "SKY" group—Seoul National University (SNU), Korea University, and Yonsei University. Therefore, it is undeniable that there have been a considerable number of corrupt incidents of college admission, especially in which the sons and daughters of high-ranking government officials are involved.

Although the Netflix Series *Juvenile Justice* contains a plethora of social problems related to juvenile crimes gathering high attention from Koreans, one of the juvenile crimes most relevant to high school students in Korea including KMLA concerns college admission. In *Juvenile Justice*, the oldest son of a head judge from a Juvenile Court, Kang Won-Joong, had been a member of a club where the teacher in charge leaked test papers and answer sheets. The son dropped out of the club right before the final exam to avoid the investigation of the police. As the son and his mother expected, the police and prosecution could not keep him in line-up because he was not in the club when the test was ongoing. However, the fact that he was involved in the case was revealed by the other judges in the court, Sim Eun-Seok and Cha Tae-Ju. In the end, the two judges charged the students who received the test papers earlier than others as guilty.

To dig into this issue of Korean college admission from the KMLA perspective, we conducted two interviews with KMLA teachers from the Department of Social Science Gwak So-Hyun, a sociology teacher who majored in philosophy and Hwang So-Hee, a politics teacher who majored in political thought.

What do you think of recent cases that reveal corrupt college admissions?
High-ranking officials and their spouses are unable to act on rational judgment. They ignore that it is wrongful to let their children get good grades and evaluations at school by taking advantage of the power and positions of the parents.

What do you think of the current Korean college admission system?
It is desirable that more students focus on early admission because the early can reflect what the students themselves think, love, and are interested in. Also, the results of the activities they have done at school can easily be noticed by colleges. However, regular admission should exist for those who do not have their own determined values in life. The regular in Korea is more advantageous to model students than those whose individualities are emphasized and recognized easily. The shortage of the regular is forcing students to memorize what is so-called "common sense" and producing mass of those who are subjected by the power of groups composed of plural members.

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What can be solutions or remedies that will improve our college admission system, especially in a view of morality/ethics?
Korean students are predisposed to not grow up independently but depend on their parents too much regardless of how old they are. However, they should not limit the future but go ahead with their own determined dreams. Failure is a chance to mature. Also, it is unnecessary for them to be obsessed by how affluent their families are or what social positions their parents are in.

The so-called "gold spoon and dirt spoon" (have and have-nots) is a mere framework the media have fostered. Ultimately, students must not feel timid. If they work on their dreams steadily and intensely, they will find their own routes. Korean parents should never utilize their children as a mere tool for belated self-realization.

The second interview was with Ms. Hwang.

What do you think of recent cases that reveal corrupt college admissions?
In the past, the college admission procedure was not as complex as today. That is the reason why the corrupt college admission was not the mainstream of social discussions. However, nowadays they are being verified so that students can cheat much more cunningly and skillfully. Another reason that has triggered the immorality of those who are related to college entrance is because isonomy, social and/or economic inequality, is being accelerated. So many things in our lives are up to the social status that colleges from which we graduated determines. The alertness that restrains immorality is becoming weaker and weaker.

What do you think of the current Korean college admission system?
It is not appropriate that the Ministry of Education focuses only on the KSAT due to "fairness." It seems inevitable to maintain the KSAT system in South Korea for the students whose social and/or economic positions are middle-low, especially those who do not afford to prepare for the Extra Curriculum for the early admission. because they do not have as much information as those whose grades are higher. Nevertheless, the KSAT admission must be abolished ideally.

The KSAT admission system makes the public school education desolated because students do not have to take classes unrelated to KSAT. This leads to high school education aimed not for study, but for the test.

What can be solutions or remedies that will improve our college admission system, especially in the view of alumni? (Ms. Hwang is a graduate of KMLA, which means she is one of our alumni.)
If Korean education is generally recognized as one of the major routes to get more decent jobs and higher honor in the society, any education system will deteriorate and lose its true meaning. Unless the recognition of the society does change, there will be no clear solution for this social problem. Therefore, I believe that KMLA students can help improve the general recognition of education itself in South Korea.

It should be prioritized for us, KMLAians, to practice the school motto including the founding philosophy of the late Choi Myeong-Jae, the founder of KMLA. The school motto reads: "Do not learn to succeed; learn for the purpose of learning. Do not choose occupations for success; choose those suitable for one's talent and aptitude. This is my true happiness and tomorrow's bright homeland." KMLA students who follow and respect this school motto will be a strong reminder to the Korean people of the true meanings of education.

Junior Writer
Park Kyuhyun

Facebook is the mainstream social media platform at Korean Minjok Leadership Academy. It is used for numerous purposes, manifested in the various Facebook groups students use daily. Facebook significantly influences the daily life of KMLAians, creating both positive and negative impacts. This article examines the usage, opinion, and impact of Facebook on KMLA life.

USING FACEBOOK IN KMLA

According to a survey of 78 KMLA students, 91% of respondents replied that they use Facebook mostly to check announcements. Supporting this, the survey shows that Facebook groups for posting announcements and notices—such as *Minsago Meok9 Sa9 Pal9* and *KMLA Jeonchegongji*—are often used. That being said, the most popular group is *Minsago Meok9 Sa9 Pal9*, a group students use for trading food and other supplies, such as clothes and stationeries. Here, it is illustrated that Facebook is used for both public and private affairs—making it almost like a digital school. With a platform where the whole school can actively interact, students are able to experience various activities—such as trading, making announcements, holding surveys, etc.

Students are generally satisfied with using Facebook for school-related purposes. To the question "What is your general opinion on using Facebook as the online platform for KMLA?," 44.2% of the participants commented that they were "satisfied" with it, and 27.3% replied "normal". For Facebook's pros, they listed "being able to do various things—such as checking announcements, trading with other students—on a single platform (52.5%)", "being able to contact anyone in KMLA via Facebook message (39.7%)", and "being able to use it on various devices, including phones, tablets, and laptops (7.7%)".

Emphasizing the efficiency of Facebook, 27th waver Park Ju-Hyeon remarked: "I think Facebook is the best platform for making official announcements since Twitter has a bad reputation and Instagram requires posting images. Moreover, Facebook is handy to use as it is possible to make groups." She also mentioned Facebook's characteristics related to social activities, saying that "One good thing about Facebook is that there is less chance of feeling relative deprivation. As Facebook is not as fancy or trendy as Instagram, and as you don't get to decorate your profile the way you do on Instagram, you don't feel so stressed on Facebook."

However, not all are happy about using Facebook as the mainstream platform. One-tenth(11.7%) of survey participants were "dissatisfied", and 3.9% were "very dissatisfied". What they found problematic was "not being able to carefully check the notices due to the numerous groups (51.3%)", "notifications that do not pop up properly (29.5%)", and "having to use social media too much (17.9%)". 27th waver Park Ji-Hu criticized Facebook's notification system, commenting that "Facebook is so inconvenient as notifications do not pop up in chronological order."

Facebook, a platform with both pros and cons, significantly affects KMLAians' life. As important announcements are posted, it is mandatory for students to frequently check Facebook. Moreover, social life also occurs via Facebook since students mostly use Facebook messages to contact one another. Since both public and private affairs related to school are held using Facebook, students are logged in every day. Some students even noted that the time they spend on social media has increased since Facebook is widely used at school. 27th waver Park Ji-Hu reflected that "I spend too much time on social media since I started using Facebook for school." It is evident that Facebook influences the lifestyle of KMLAians.

Facebook allows KMLAians to be connected to the school 24/7. It is similar to dormitory life in a sense, as school life is part of your whole day. This is especially true since Facebook covers a wide range of activities. Facebook notifications often interrupt one's peaceful solitude by constantly providing information. As smartphones, tablet PCs, and laptops are inseparable from most students, it is common for students to habitually open Facebook. The result of such routine is one's individual identity being replaced with social incidents, being deprived of the time to be truly oneself, instead of a member of KMLA. Notwithstanding its exhaustion, if used wisely, both dormitory life and Facebook can result in the greatest pleasures. Like the slogan of Facebook–'Move fast and break things'–*move* your thumbs *fast* only when you must check important notifications, and *break* the myth that you must be online all day to catch up with your friends. Logging out when necessary leads to the wise usage of Facebook as the mainstream school social media platform.

Junior Writer
Park Nae-Young

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STUDENT AUTONOMOUS SYSTEM INSIDE AND OUTSIDE KMLA

Junior Writer I Lee Somyung

'The school should recommend and protect students' autonomous activities.'

This is Article 12 of the higher education law of Korea, amended in 2011. As you can see here, Korean education emphasizes student autonomy systems. In the past, unconditionally following a teacher's directions was regarded as polite, and students making their voices heard were often regarded as rude and disrespectful toward teachers. But things have changed in recent years. According to the survey made by Jeollabuk-do Province educational policy institute, nearly 80% of students and teachers responded that their schools are applying policies that secure students' autonomous activities. Schools and laws are encouraging students to manage things independently.

So, it is obvious that the Korean Ministry of Education and individual schools are all aware of the significance of student autonomy. But it makes us question the reason student autonomy is so important. The value of the student autonomy system can be examined from two examples.

First is the voter turnout of 19 and 20-year-olds, which increased by more than 20%p in 2012 compared with 2007. Considering that the educational law was amended in 2011, we can say conclusively that the activated student autonomy system affected the voter turnout for Korea's next generation.

The second example is the employee recruitment standard of most domestic and multinational companies. Google, which is a representative multinational corporation, identified their most prioritized employee quality as job competency, which is enhanced through experience. Those who steadily participate in student autonomous activities can earn these qualities even in their early 20s, which is a huge benefit when searching for employment.

Korean Minjok Leadership Academy is one of the schools carrying out the most advanced student autonomy system in Korea. From classroom activities to lifestyle, the student's everyday life in KMLA is proceeded by participation.

To begin with, KMLA has three main student autonomy councils; judicial, executive, and legislative. Each plays a major role in operating student autonomous activities. For example, the judicial council sets the standards to make a judgment on whether students are guilty or not. As the students make decisions about the innocence of other students, they become more responsible in abiding by the rules and setting just standards. The members of the councils are elected by the student election. This shows that power is equally distributed to every student, ensuring that everyone in our school is participating in the student autonomy system.

Next, school clubs are operated by students. There are hundreds of clubs in KMLA, and the number increases year by year. Most plans and outside activities are, for the most part, completely organized and conducted by the students. It is common for the 11th graders in a club to select new members from the freshmen, educating and instructing them on how to carry out activities. Of course, there are some aspects that require teacher assistance and supervision, but most tasks are completed by the students themselves.

The special feature of KMLA is that there are school departments run by the students. There are 12 departments, similar to the administrative departments of the Korean government. Each assumes a significant role in every aspect of a student's school life. For example, the department of justice lists the students who received penalty points and ensures that students are paying attention to the judge at student court.

The problem is that, despite the apparent advantage of independent activities, the scope of the student's autonomous activities is limited to simply *TEEN Courts**or carrying out class councils in most high schools in Korea. These constrictions are partially rooted in the indifference of the students. In the interview with the member of legislative counsel, she mentioned that even though it is true that KMLA students participate more actively in students' autonomous activities compared with other schools in Korea, it is still deficient to function the student autonomy system smoothly.

Then what do we need to do to solve these problems and expand the range of students' self-determining activities? First, we should call for the participation of every school member. Participation of the students is the key to the student autonomy system. If few students are interested in autonomous activities, it will be of no use to implement such activities, and it will have a limited impact on students' lives. In an effort to motivate the students' participation, they should be informed of the clear advantage of such activities. For example, by taking a part in student autonomous activities, they could change school policies that they regard as unreasonable. Also, they can implement new policies which could highly alleviate their burden in lives. If the students fully recognize these benefits, they would actively participate in these self-determining activities.

Second, it is important to clarify a strict line between what can be allowed as a student's autonomy and what is the right of the teachers. As the teachers are solicitous about protecting the students' right to make decisions by themselves, the students should always respect and appreciate their efforts.

This way, we will be able to develop students' autonomy in a wider scope, which is also achieving the ultimate goal of the school: to prepare students to become part of society.

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K-pop continually grows towards acceptance within mainstream music every single day. This becomes even more clear when we look into KMLA, as K-popfangirls/fanboys make up a large section of our student community. They buy photocards of their favorite idol members, pay for expensive concert tickets, and even make excuses to leave school to attend them. K-pop has transformed into a global trend, and idols are no longer just simple singers or dancers, but also influencers in fashion, culture, and global issues etc. Rather than just being known for the finger heart sign or kimchi, Korea's image has expanded into a point of inspiration for global culture. It's not an exaggeration to say that there is K-pop at the core of Korea's national identity.

From the mid-2000s to the early 2010s, the spread of the Korean Wave was mainly led by Korean boy groups and girl groups called idol stars, such as Big Bang, Girl's Generation, and Kara. Through Korean Wave, Psy's "Gangnam Style '' maintained its ranking as No.2 on the Billboard Hot 100 for seven consecutive weeks and finally reached three billion views on Youtube in 2012.

The worldwide success of "Gangnam Style '' was followed by the surge of the K-pop boy group, BTS. BTS has shown some of the greatest achievements possible in mainstream music; for example, they landed atop the Billboard 200 chart in February 2020, achieved various Guinness World Record titles, and became the first Korean act to top the Billboard Hot 100 with its first English language song "Dynamite."

Recently, K-pop has been pursuing diversification. While idol groups still play a pivotal role, indie pop musicians are also taking big strides in making successful careers. Collaboration between idol groups and indie musicians adds diversity to the genre.

However, even though K-pop is growing day by day, there are varying opinions. Some believe that K-pop has already become mainstream music, and will remain as a steady trend for a long time, while others believe K-pop is a temporary fad. Which view holds the most truth?

K-POP

MAINSTREAM MUSIC OR FAD?



PHOTO SOURCE: THE RECORDING ACADEMY

THERE IS NO ACCURATE STANDARD TO VERIFY FAD AND MAINSTREAM MUSIC. HOWEVER, IF K-POP IS MAINSTREAM MUSIC, IT WILL BE MUSIC THAT MANY PEOPLE AROUND THE WORLD AS WELL AS KOREA HAVE BEEN ENTHUSIASTIC ABOUT FOR A LONG TIME, AND IF IT IS A FAD, IT WILL BE A GENRE OF MUSIC THAT IS GRADUALLY LOSING PERFORMANCE AND ACHIEVEMENTS. WHICH IS MORE CHARACTERISTIC OF K-POP?

K-POP IS A CONTROVERSIAL TOPIC BECAUSE THERE ARE BOTH POSITIVE AND NEGATIVE ASPECTS TO THE CULTURE IT DERIVES ITSELF FROM AND THE EVOLVING ONE IT THUS CREATES. HOWEVER, IT IS TRUE THAT K-POP HAS BECOME A BIG AND SUSTAINED TREND THAT HAS CEMENTED ITSELF BEYOND KOREA. WHAT DO YOU THINK ABOUT THE K-POP TREND? IS THIS SOMETHING KOREA SHOULD BE PROUD OF AND EMBRACE, OR SHOULD IT BE VIEWED AS A PASSING FAD OF LITTLE VALUE?

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"K-POP IS JUST A *FAD*"

On the other hand, many feel that K-pop is a short fad. They believe K-pop became successful due to the visuals or, in simple terms, good looking performers Powered by Korea's inherent lookism and massive beauty industry, K-pop is famous for putting pretty faces ahead of talent, and the world has taken notice. We can easily see the tendency of K-pop companies that pick talent based on looks instead of skill as a second priority. Often, this tendency results in K-pop groups debuting and quickly being exposed for lack of artistic capacity. Just looking at Youtube comments, one can sense a lot of focus on K-pop idols' appearances instead of talent or musical skill. Compared to the comments praising western artists such as Adele, Meghan Trainor, or Lizzo who are valued for talent, it is easy to criticize K-pop for promoting "lookism". Influenced by appearance-oriented media, the young generation is highly influenced to try extreme weight loss or even plastic surgery. Related to this is another negative impact of K-pop, which is the sexualization of idols. Most outfits worn by idols are revealing, and female performers are encouraged to wear the shortest dresses possible. To go even further into reasons that prevent K-pop from being taken seriously, there is the toxic nature of fandom culture. K-pop contains a huge population of toxic fans who always compare their idols with other idols and insult them. This culture can even grow into physical violence between fandom.

Senior Writer | Ha Ji-MIn

VS

People who believe K-pop is mainstream music say K-pop is not only a culture for Korea, but for the world. The reason why they believe it is mainstream is because K-pop's influence is rapidly growing. As social media and streaming platforms have evolved, so too has an ultra-socially engaged fan base – one that not only devotes entire Twitter accounts to sending artists up the Billboard charts, but also buys out arenas and religiously tunes in to splashy TV specials, sending Korean acts ever nearer to the forefront of American pop. Dick Clark Productions airs both the BBMAs and AMAs, and the company credits its initial interest in BTS and K-pop with their growing American followings on social media. The executive VP of brand marketing and digital strategy at DCP, Ariel Elazer, said "It was the Billboard charts that indicated that K-pop was now a big part of the music scene in the U.S.." Jeremy Lowe, a senior manager on the same DCP team, points out that such televised events offer K-pop artists access not only to a much wider U.S audience, but also to Western acts with whom they might make chart hits with in the future. With expanding listenership at their disposal, K-pop artists and the companies that steer their careers are approaching the U.S. market differently. The U.S industry experts suggest that BTS' dedication to touring frequently in the United States is influenced by other acts; for example, the K-pop performance in Coachella. And they believe this kind of influence will become sustainable.

"K-POP IS *MAINSTREAM* MUSIC"



Photo Source: Goal.com
Reference: https://www.footba

Son Heung-Min, 28 years-old, a professional football player with Tottenham Hotspur who has become the English Premier League (EPL)'s top scorer, had a wonderful season this year. He competed with Mohamed Salah, who charged the attack of Liverpool, to score goals. Even if they scored the same number of goals–23–in total, Son was considered the best footballer of the season because he made an impressive achievement which is the record of scoring 23 goals without any penalty goals, whereas Salah made many goals with penalty kicks. What made him become the top player in EPL, and what is behind his miraculous accomplishments? This article examines his hidden efforts that were overshadowed by the results.

Son Heung-Min was born in *Chuncheon-si*, *Gangwon-do*. Although he was born in a small town, he went through the training from his father, Son Woong-Jeong, who was a professional footballer before his son's birth. His father played a pivotal role in Son Heung-Min's rise to stardom. He trained his son based on his own experience, emphasizing the importance of practicing the basics of football for years. Son went through extreme workouts, including a thousand reps of shooting practice for each leg, and thousands of double under jump rope exercises. Because of his father's extreme workout, Son was equipped with "basic" which was his father's priority, eventually making him use both legs freely with astounding speed. According to his interview, he said he never had a single day off, even in harsh weather, and eventually the practices became his ritual.

Furthermore, he had a lot of difficulties in his life in Germany. He went abroad when he was 17. Since it was his first time living in foreign country, he spent a long time adapting to the environment.
Also, he racial discriminated against from a member on the same team. These hardships exhausted Son, both mentally and physically. However, he was able to get emotional support from his father. He received a lot of advice and gradually gained confidence. No matter what the others said, he devoted himself to football.

Overcoming these adversities, he became the top player, not only in Korea, but in the world. Son's passion and persistence in soccer set him up for all the miraculous achievements. He even has made major contributions to the development of Korean soccer by holding soccer competitions and providing a vast soccer stadium for next-generation players to practice in.

Similar to how Son had a lot of hardships in his teens, KMLAians would definitely suffer from various stresses. They have various activities from club activities to student department duties to attend to. Continuous morning exercises would be another factor of sleepiness. KMLAians tend to be physically worn out because of these numerous activities. Also, conflicts are inevitable as various students who grew up in different environments live together in the dormitory.

To overcome these problems, they should first trust themselves. No matter what the others say, they should keep believing in themselves and escape from discouragement. Secondly, rather than getting stressed from diverse activities, they should be responsible for the activities and passionately take part in them. This attitude will set KMLAians up for success, just as Son Heung-Min.

Junior Writer
Park Hyun-Jun

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source: gettyimages

THE LOST GRACE OF THE MET GALA

The Met Gala, the most elegant of all fashion events, is known to us as a costume party of celebrities in ridiculous dresses that could not be further away from elegance. At a gathering of the wealthiest, most famous, and most well-dressed people, the most lasting image we have is of Kim Kardashian destroying Marilyn Monroe's historical dress. It is safe to say that in recent days, the most grandiose fashion event in the world has lost its luster.

Before discussing what is wrong with the Met Gala, let's find out what exactly it is. More formally known as the Costume Institute Gala, the event is a fundraising showcase for the Metropolitan Museum of Art's Costume Institute. Held annually in New York City on the first Monday of May, the Met Gala was started in 1948 by Eleanor Lambert, an American fashion publicist. At the time, the Met Gala was a fairly small and private event, with guests primarily from New York's high society. Up to 1971, the Gala retained its modesty, until celebrities started attending the event. This made the Met Gala the powerhouse of attention it is today.

The Met Gala has a theme and a dress code that is issued each year, but it has always been an unenforced recommendation. However, it is tradition to follow the theme and the more specific dress code.

The dress code this year was Gilded Glamour and White Tie. The theme broadly refers to all of the historical fashion of America, while the dress code refers to the period of the Gilded Age, which lasted from 1870 to 1900. Following the dress code is where most attendees had a problem.

The Gilded Age, which inspired the Gilded Glamour theme, was a period of rapid growth in the United States. This was when the second industrial revolution was at its peak, and when the economic growth of the US began to exceed the industrialization of Europe. Fashion changed in accordance with society. Everything about the outfits was exaggerated and luxurious: women of the high class wore dresses in bustle form, with floor-length skirts and princess-line corsets. White tie, the latter part of the dress code refers to the white ties and tuxedos men wore at this time, which was when it first became popularized.

The Gilded Age was not all so gilded, or gold-covered. Behind all of the rapid growth were immigrants and lower-class workers. The term, the Gilded Age, was one that was coined by Mark Twain in his novel *The Gilded Age: a Tale of Today*, to emphasize the irony that the dichotomy of wealth and extreme poverty presented.

The dress code of the Met Gala was criticized for this reason: how could America celebrate the iconically unequal Gilded Age in the time of COVID-19, when inequality has soared higher than ever in modern times? Considering that most of the attendees, who were mostly celebrities funded by luxury brands, publicly honored the wealth earned by the blood and sweat of laborers are painfully ironic. It seems that the dress code this year was meant to rub the wrong way from the beginning.



Women wearing dresses with a bustle
Source: Library of Congress

Even overlooking the insensitive social connotations behind the dress code and theme, the fact that most of those attendees did not follow the code altogether is infuriating. Kim Kardashian wore Marilyn Monroe's original dress which is iconic for being worn to John F. Kennedy's birthday party in 1962.

Kylie Jenner wore a modern-style wedding dress and a veil on a baseball cap. With most of the A-list celebrities completely missing the mark, this year's Met Gala is called a failure by the public. And the fact is, this phenomenon is not exclusive to the 2022 Met Gala alone. For years, more and more celebrities chose outfits that did not fit the theme, each year more blatantly than before.

One must ask the question, why are so many of the attendees unable to follow the dress code? Seeing how they have the most famous fashion brands in the world sponsoring them and paying the $35,000 fee for them to attend this event, it seems almost ridiculous. The answer is probably: for attention. Respecting the tradition of the Gala is beyond the celebrities' goal of looking the most glamorous on social media.

From the moment celebrities were invited, the Met Gala had begun its transformation from a high-society fashion event to a publicity stunt. Fashion is an art that should be respected and cherished. Although not all, too many celebrities consider the event nothing more than a career builder, a marketing strategy.

For artistic freedom, the Met Gala had given its guests the liberty to not follow their theme. In spite of that, celebrities have abused their freedom and used it for their own selfish purposes. If we, the public, are to enjoy the elegance and depth of the fashion world at the Met Gala again, it is crucial that celebrities take into account the elegance of the grandest fashion event in the world.

Junor Writer
Choi Serim

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A Day in the Life

Today was the worst day of my life.

This is how it began; I squinted open my eyes for a moment. It was raining and still too dark outside, so I shut them again to sleep. Then I woke up again. However, it was strange. I felt refreshed, too refreshed. I knew for sure that this wasn't the state I was supposed to be in if I had woken up at the right time. I knew for sure.

"OMG... I woke up late." The time was as I supposed, 7:18. *Hahaha. Starting my day with 3 penalty points, isn't it amazing?* I thought to myself.

Soon my roommates entered. They were back from morning exercise and had already eaten breakfast. Meanwhile, I prepared for school and went to cafeteria. After I finished breakfast, I waited for the elevator as time continued to run out. Yet, the elevator showed no signs of moving, so I rushed down the stairs as fast as I could. However, when I was heading to the fourth floor, I heard a student of the Department of School Guidance shouting out:

"Ten seconds left!!!"

Why wasn't I able to hear the previous warnings?

I ran and ran and ran. I *really* didn't want to be caught late. However, things don't always go as we hope, do they? The person right in front of me passed just in time, but I was a step behind and was accused of "tardiness". In momentary anger, I let out some harsh words. Oh my my... a teacher heard me and accused me of an "insolent attitude." To make matters worse, I was charged with penalty points yet again for speaking Korean while passing the patrollers from the Department of English Only Policy.

I wondered if this day could get any worse. Luckily, my classes went fine and I made it to dinner time without causing other disasters. The menu was amazing. Spaghetti, a slice of pizza, tomato caprese salad, and waffles. I filled the entire plate with food and was happily devouring it. Suddenly, I wasn't feeling good. I couldn't eat anymore. My attempts to still try and finish my plate failed, and my dinner ended with a "food violation."

When the first self-study period started I was preparing to go to student court, as I was absent from the last court session and was therefore charged with penalty points. I left the dorm a little early so as not to be late, but poor me. I misconceived the time and arrived late.

"Ha. Penalty points added," I spoke to myself.

During court, I was so sleepy as I was so full from dinner, and the gym was so warm, so I couldn't help but doze off. Unfortunately, at that moment, the Department of Justice charged me with "insolent attitude." Soon, I was called to the stand, but while I was standing I forgot to tie my hair, and it covered my name tag. And yes, I got extra penalty points for name tag violation.

After the court, I returned to my dorm room just in time for *honjeong*. Oh no! It was then that I realized that I didn't check my temperature after I returned from school, and this would result in more penalty points for "not following the teacher's direction."

Amazing... Was getting this many penalty points in a row even possible?! I thought to myself.

Time passed, and it was now five to twelve. I had a book to return to my friend, so I hastily went downstairs (as she lives on the 7th floor and I live on the 8th). But time went much faster than I thought, and as I was heading back to my room the housemistress stopped me.

"Why are you out of your room at this time? You are not supposed to be fooling around here!"

"Sorry miss... I had something to return to my friend..."

I headed to my room. It was time for all the lights to go off as I climbed up the ladder to my bed to sleep.

Today was a spectacular day that I never want to relive again, I thought over and over and over as I fell asleep.

Junior Writer
Kim Do-Gyeong

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Lovers' Woe

Seol Hojun

Once stood an icy desert land
Shone callous moon on freezing sand
No water, earth or standing tree
Just ice, wind and sand set free

Upon the gaze of twilight eye
Frozen still, the land did sigh
Left to wither all alone
Color bleached as white as bone.

One fateful, ordinary night,
A sun appeared with shining light
Soft warmness came upon the sands
At last did melt, the frigid lands

Five months and one, the sun did shine
Up every day, with moon in line
New life began upon the ground
May land and sun be ever bound

Yet all things bound must break

One night, the light did fade untold
And once again, the land grew cold
It cried in pain, searching out
But nowhere was the sun about

The life that bloomed to wilt and die
To hold its broken heart and cry
Even now, it moans in pain
Reliving memories in vain



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ENERGY DRINK

Seol Hojun

In my tired body flows
a liquid filled with alchemic life
Caffeine opens my weary eyes
Taurine beats my tired heart

But my mind lies dead.

Like the Schrödinger's cat,
I stand in the junction of splitting worlds

Am I dead or alive?
Am I awake or asleep?
There is no answer and yet there is

I am both dead and alive, awake and asleep

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MOVIES TO WATCH AFTER THE FINALS

BY JIN YURIM, SENIOR WRITER

Every year after studying for the grueling exam, students are excited about the upcoming Winter Festival. Some anticipate their winter vacations. But this is when we need to be careful. It's not that everything is over once the exams are finished. After the exams is the time to rethink our lives, career paths, and relationships. So rather than wasting your time goofing around facebook, what about watching a nice movie that will refresh your thoughts and boost you again?



The main character, Hye-Won, was preparing to be a teacher, but failed the test, while her boyfriend passed. Along with various problems in the city, Hye-Won leaves for her hometown. It wasn't a planned visit, but life in the country was more pleasing than she expected. So inadvertently, she gets to spend almost a year at the 'forest', where there are crops and fields, farms and animals, instead of the busy streets and businessmen. Life in the city resembles our life in KMLA. Although our school is located in a remote area immersed in nature, the students endure ridiculously busy schedules, and often stay up late at night.

So during vacation, as our finals also ended, why don't we all take a time to relax and look around? Like Hye-Won, who fled from the heavy competition in the city, and resorted to cooking simple dishes from home-made lettuces, kimchi, onions, even flowers. While watching the movie, I gradually felt relaxed, and realized the importance of "tuning out". Even though I never lived in such a countryside, I could feel the innocent breeze and calming atmosphere that Hye-Won would have felt in her hometown. I believe that all of you would find the opportunity to rest your mind and rethink the course of your lives after you watch the movie.

LITTLE FOREST, 2015

KIM JI-YOUNG, BORN 1982, 2019

Many of you might have watched it, since the movie is based on a renowned book written by Cho Nam-Ju. The book was associated with rumors about feminism and prejudice against men, but I disagree. The movie merely tells you about what it is like to be a mother in South Korea without any fake or editing. It voices out the struggles and dilemma of a middle-aged women with a child. I watched this movie when I was about 15 years old, and it was the first time I really grasped the burden of being a mother. If I watch it again today, at the age of 18, it would definitely be a different experience.

The reason I recommend this movie especially to KMLA students is because we lack the opportunity to understand our family members, our parents, in particular. We often overlook their contributions and efforts. A lot of my friends fight with their mothers regarding their grades and school life, and the majority of them just neglect the trouble and continue on studying. It's not easy to deal with the conflicts with our parents thoroughly while school life is extremely busy. But the relationship with our most loved ones might be more important than getting a good grade. Now is the time to focus back on our home, our family. Before you go back home on 13th of July, watch this movie, and your perspective toward your parents would totally change.



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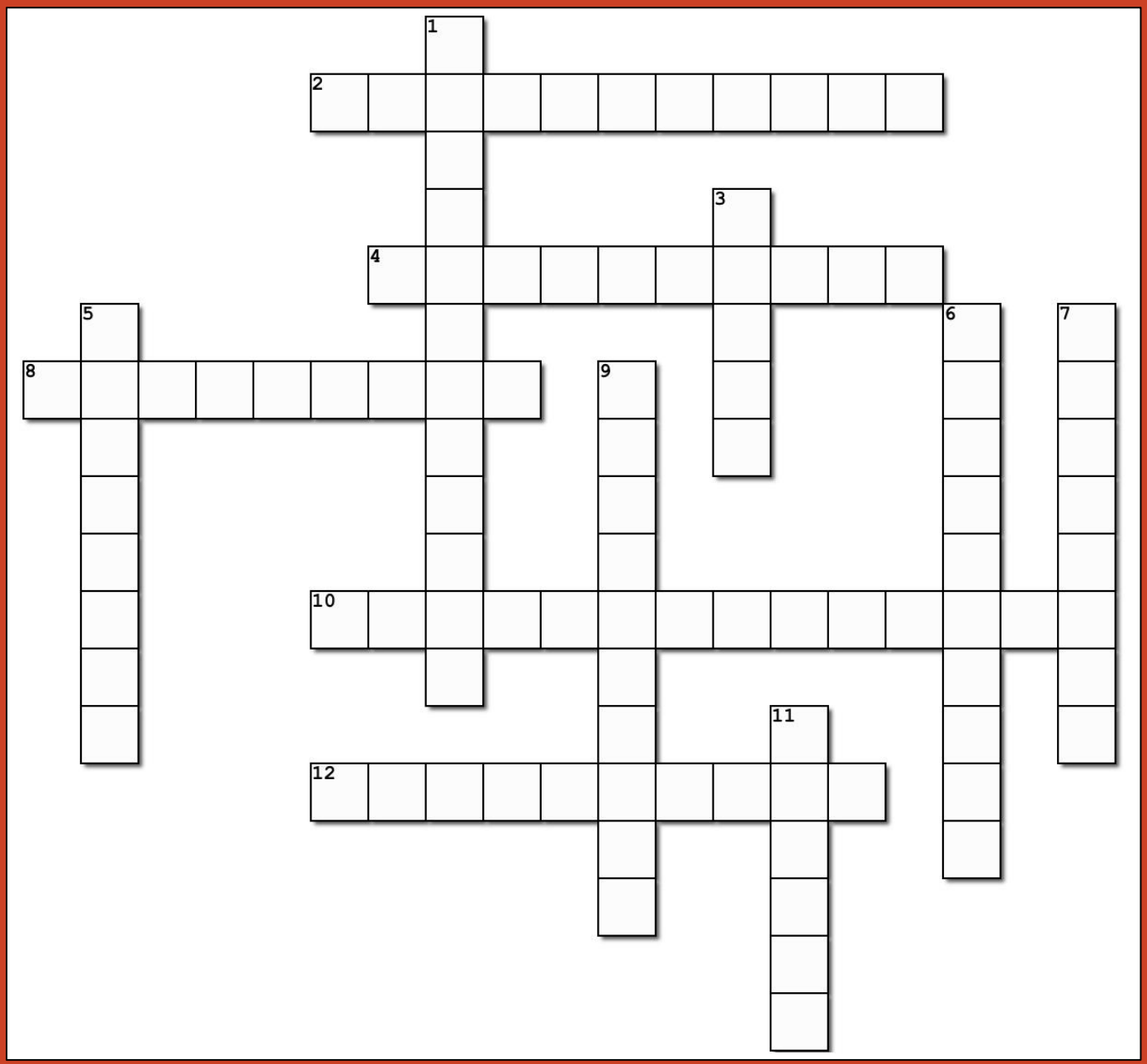
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MINJOK HERALD 67TH EDITION

CROSSWORD PUZZLE



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CROSSWORD PUZZLE

ACROSS

2. THE NUMBER OF GOALS SON SCORED TO BECOME EPL'S MOST-SCORING PLAYER

4. PROFESSOR CHONG JO-WOON TEACHES ( ) ENGINEERING.

8. WHICH TYPE OF WATER IS SAFER TO DRINK WHEN YOU ARE ISOLATED IN A MOUNTAIN? STREAM WATER OR RAIN WATER?

10. WHAT IS THE NAME OF THE ADVISING TEACHER FOR MINJOK HERALD?

12. WHAT IS THE NAME OF THE CLUB THAT COLLABORATED WITH MJH ON THIS ISSUE?

DOWN

1. WHAT USED TO EXIST IN THE KMLA DORMS THAT ENABLED STUDENTS TO KEEP THEIR FOOD COOL?

3. WHO IS THE PRAGMATIST LEADER AMONG THE LEADERS MENTIONED IN THE ARTICLE "HOW CAN THE BURNING CANDLES LEAD THE WORLD?"

5. WHAT IS THE MAINSTREAM SOCIAL MEDIA USED IN KMLA?

6. WHO IS THE 10TH GRADE REPRESENTATIVE COUNSELING ADVISOR?

7. WHAT IS THE NAME OF THE EX-NAVY SEAL OFFICER WHO LEFT FOR UKRAINE TO FIGHT IN THE RUSSO-UKRANIAN WAR?

9. WHAT DO YOU CALL THE SCHOOL, COLLEGE, OR UNIVERSITY THAT ONE ONCE ATTENDED ?

11. PEOPLE WHO HAVE GRADUATED FROM A CERTAIN SCHOOL IS CALLED THE ( ) OF THAT SCHOOL.

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"Your education is a dress rehearsal for a life that is yours to lead"

- NORA EPHRON



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